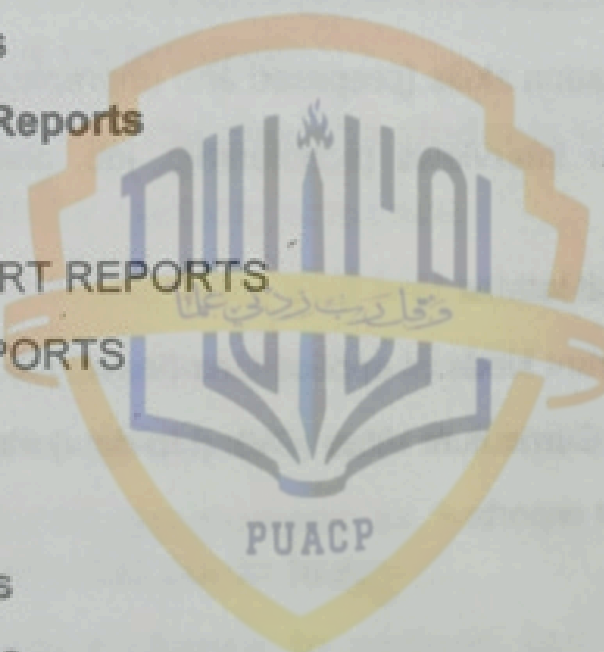


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A Textbook Of English - III (Advance Communication Skills) Semester-III by Famous



Code	Subject Title	Cr. Hrs	Semester
ENG-201	English-III (Advance Communication Skills)	3	III
Year	Discipline		
2	English		

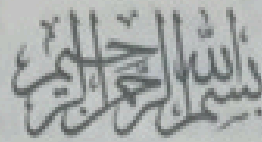
Aims:

To enable the students to meet their real life communication needs

Contents:

- Oral presentation skills (prepared and unprepared talks)
- Preparing for interviews (scholarship, job, placement for internship, etc.)
- Writing formal letters
- Writing different kinds of applications (leave, job, complaint, etc.)
- Preparing a Curriculum Vitae (CV), (bio-data) etc.
- Writing short reports

PUACP



Chapter 1

Oral Presentation Skills (Prepared And Unprepared Talks)

Student's Learning Outcomes:

After completing this chapter, the students will be able to;

- Think about the opening sentence.
- Look around at audience and feel relaxed.
- Speak and act in a confident manner.
- Maintain good eye-contact with the audience.
- The speaker is spontaneous as he/ she says what he/ she feels, not what ought to say.
- Speaker gets a chance to express his/ her thoughts irrespective of what participants think or say about that specific topic.
- The speaker is natural in delivery because he/ she does not get enough time for preparation.

ORAL PRESENTATION SKILLS

Introduction

Oral presentations, also known as public speaking or simply presentations, consist of an individual or group verbally addressing an audience on a particular topic. The aim of this is to educate, inform, entertain or present an argument. Oral presentations are seen within workplaces, classrooms and even

needed

Def. purpose

70 Judge
 at social events such as weddings. An oral presentation at university assesses the presenter's ability to communicate relevant information effectively in an interesting and engaging manner. In some instances, you may be required to present as part of a group to test your ability to work as a member of a team. Working within a group can sometimes be a challenge or a great success. To understand how to effectively work in a group, take a look at our Group Work resource. The most important factors for a successful presentation are: careful planning, lots of practice and engaging the audience. It's a good idea to watch some professional presentations online to get a sense of what good speakers do. Oral presentation skills are related with prepared and unprepared talks.

Oral Presentations

Giving an oral presentation as part of a speaking exam can be quite scary, but we're here to help you. Watch two students giving presentations and then read the tips carefully.

It's not easy to give a good oral presentation but these tips will help you. Here are our top tips for oral presentations.

Do:

- ① • Use the planning time to prepare what you're going to say.
- If you are allowed to have a note card, write short notes in point form.
- ② • Use more formal language.
- Use short, simple sentences to express your ideas clearly.
4. • Pause from time to time and don't speak too quickly. This allows the listener to understand your ideas. Include a short pause after each idea.
- Speak clearly and at the right volume.
- Have your notes ready in case you forget anything.
- Practise your presentation. If possible record yourself and listen to your presentation. If you can't record

yourself, ask a friend to listen to you. Does your friend understand you?

- Make your opinions very clear. Use expressions to give your opinion.
- Look at the people who are listening to you.

Don't:

- Write out the whole presentation and learn every word by heart.
- Write out the whole presentation and read it aloud.
- Use very informal language.
- Only look at your note card. It's important to look up at your listeners when you are speaking.

Useful language for presentations

Explain what your presentation is about at the beginning:

I'm going to talk about ...

I'd like to talk about ...

The main focus of this presentation is ...

Use these expressions to order your ideas:

First of all, ...

Firstly, ...

Then, ...

Secondly, ...

Next, ...

Finally, ...

Lastly, ...

To sum up, ...

In conclusion, ...

Use these expressions to add more ideas from the same point of view:

In addition, ...

What's more, ...

Also, ...

Added to this, ...

To introduce the opposite point of view you can use these words and expressions:

However, ...

On the other hand, ...

Then again, ...

Example presentation topics

- Violent computer games should be banned.
- The sale of cigarettes should be made illegal.
- Homework should be limited to just two nights a week.
- Should school students be required to wear a school uniform?
- How to become the most popular teen in school.
- Dogs should be banned from cities.

Like anything else, oral presentations become easier with preparation and practice.

I. Sign up early.

Although doing your presentation first isn't a great idea because you don't have the chance to note the strengths and weaknesses of other presenters/presentations, be careful not to wait too long.

- If you go early, you have a greater chance of being "original"—sometimes, if you delay your presentation,

you get a "great" idea...and then someone else grabs it first.

- Often the beginning of a semester is less crowded with other assignments, tests, etc. than the middle or the end. It's useful to do your presentation when you're not panicking about getting other things done.
- It's nice to get oral presentations out of the way—that way you can relax and enjoy the other guy's show!

II. It helps to know what's expected of you

Before you start researching your project, it's a good idea to ask your professor the following things:

- How much time do you have for your presentation?
1. Will you be expected to leave some time to address the questions of your professor or classmates?
 - What form is your seminar supposed to take?
1. Are you expected to read from a text? If so, are you expected to hand out copies of your text to your professor and classmates for consideration?
 2. Are you allowed to read from a text?
 3. Are you expected to use notes?
 4. Are you allowed to use notes?
 5. Are you expected to use various media—slides, an overhead projector, hand-outs—to illustrate points you are making?
 6. Are you allowed to use various media to illustrate points you are making?
 7. If you are expected or allowed to use media, who is going to arrange for such things as a projector and slides; an overhead projector and transparencies; the reproduction and distribution of hand-outs?

8. Is there a particular style of oral presentation that your professor expects? (Is it acceptable to simply come with a number of provocative questions? Are you in fact going to be expected to engage your peers in a discussion? Or are you only responsible for conveying a certain amount of information?)

- Are you expected to use secondary sources?
- Are you allowed to use secondary sources?
- What criteria are being used to evaluate your presentation? (Delivery? Information? Ability to field questions? etc.)

III. Choose your topic carefully.

- When selecting the topic for your presentation, it's frequently a good idea to find a particular—frequently an oblique—angle, a clear and narrow focus for your material.

IV. Define the scope of your research.

- It's important to figure out how much material you actually need to have.
1. It's better to have too much material and to cut it down during your "rehearsal" sessions than to find yourself standing there with nothing to say. BUT don't prepare a full-length essay. Remember that the good delivery of an oral presentation takes time. You want to speak slowly and clearly—you may occasionally want to repeat material for emphasis—so, in general, it will take quite a bit longer to read a paper aloud than it will to read it to yourself.

V. Organize your talk as you would an essay.

- Clear and logical organization is even more important in seminars than it is in written papers.
- Start out with a very clear thesis statement in which you outline your subject and the main points you will be addressing—in the order in which you will be addressing them.

VI. Try to make use of supplementary media to illustrate or illuminate aspects of your talk.

- The use of visual or auditory material to highlight points in your seminar will encourage your audience to attend to and remember what you are saying.
- It will also divert a roomful of staring eyes from looking at you to looking at something (anything!) else for some of the time.
- Supplementary media can include slides, overhead projections, hand-outs, segments on videotape and so on.
- Find interesting, unexpected and unusual material—but be sure that it does have direct relevance to your topic.
- Be sure, too, that you have the mechanics of your media worked out in advance—don't waste time trying to figure out how to use a slide projector or putting slides or overheads in upside down!
- Be sure to leave time, too, for a little bit of fiddling with equipment and for the visual images to sink in—remember that this may take time away from your oral presentation, so adjust your visual aids—and your presentation—accordingly.

VII. Leave time to rehearse your presentation.

- It's extremely important to leave yourself sufficient time before your presentation for rehearsal. You need to know
 1. how much to write—or how many notes to have—to fill the time;
 2. how to hold your notes so you don't just bury your head in them and read;
 3. how quickly—or slowly—to talk;
 4. whether you need to make notes on the blackboard; etc.

- Start out rehearsing by yourself.

1. Be sure you have a clock handy so that you can time yourself.
2. If you don't have enough material, look carefully at what you do have and mark places where you could expand upon points or develop more complex concepts.
3. If you have too much material, look to see where you can cut your paper down. Don't actually delete "superfluous" material. Often, though it's not ideal, you speed up when you're nervous—you might find yourself able to cover more material than you did in rehearsal. (NOTE: One way to deal with this is to highlight central points; then, if you find you have extra time, you can make use of elaborating or supporting material.)

- Practice the presentation at least three times.

1. Reading over your notes silently is not enough; you must run through the speech out loud.

- Be sure you know how to pronounce all the words in your paper. If you're not sure, look them up in a dictionary and make your own phonetic notation to let you know how to pronounce them (i.e., "mnemonic" becomes "nuh-mon-ick").

1. Say each word you're uncomfortable with 5 to 10 times to make sure you have mastered it.
2. If you keep making mistakes on any word or phrase, replace it!

- Turn your paper or notes into a script. For instance, note

1. where you're going to be emphatic;
2. where you're going to repeat points;
3. where you might make a (seemingly) casual remark, etc.

- Make sure you know your material well enough to talk comfortably without depending too much on notes.

- After mastering your wording, give your presentation in front of a mirror (or a video tape recorder).
- 1. Pay attention to any distracting habits that you might have (shuffling your feet, waving your hands excessively, playing with your hair).
- Finally, you may want to try your talk out on a very supportive and honest friend, brother, sister, dog...

VIII. It's important to feel comfortable about the way you look, and to be relaxed and confident, during your presentation.

- Make sure that you are well-rested and relatively stress-free on the day of your presentation.
- Leave lots of time to shower, eat and get dressed.
- Be sure that you have planned in advance what you are going to wear.
- 1. You don't want to be surprised to find that you have nothing clean or that you can't find a pair of matching socks.
- 2. Don't go out and buy something new to wear. You might be unpleasantly surprised to find that your new sweater drives you crazy because it's made of a particularly itchy yarn.
- 3. Above all, choose something that makes you feel comfortable and attractive.
- You may want to plan to bring something into the class with you: a cup of coffee, cough drops—but nothing too distracting—to fiddle with.

IX. Treat your presentation like a well-planned performance.

- Set the stage carefully.
- 1. Be sure you get to the class in plenty of time to see to any arrangements that need to be made (check the operating condition of VCRs, etc.).

2. If you find yourself getting nervous, practice relaxation techniques: deep breathing, the "wet-dog" shake, focusing; etc.
3. Figure out before you start talking where you're going to situate yourself for the presentation: standing at the front of the class, sitting on a desk, etc.
4. Decide what you're going to do with notes: Is there a lectern? A desk? Are you going to just hold them?

- **Stay in control.**

1. Talk slowly.
2. Talk clearly (enunciate).
3. Talk loudly.
4. Make eye contact.
5. Avoid staying in one place. Try not to simply stand or sit in one spot; it's a good idea to walk around a bit, to gesture and change the direction of your focus in order to keep all of the audience interested.
6. Be sensitive to your audience. If you notice that people are looking bored or distracted, change your position, the speed or volume of your voice.

X. Handle questions with confidence.

- Don't panic (!) when you're asked a question. Give it careful—but quick—consideration and answer it to the best of your ability.
- It's acceptable to tell someone that you don't understand his or her questions. (This is also a good way to stall for time!) Ask them to rephrase or clarify it—or rephrase it yourself and ask them if that is what they meant.
- It's also all right to admit that you're not sure about the answer to a question—sometimes a lively discussion can ensue if you turn the question over to the class.
- Try to give everyone who wants to ask a question a turn. Don't just "call on" friends.

ORAL PRESENTATION

XI. After your seminar, take time to assess your "performance."

- Ask friends in the class and the professor for their honest opinions.
1. Pose specific questions: Did you cover enough material? Did you allow enough—or too much—time for questions and discussion?
 - We improve only by asking for, and positively acting on, constructive feedback. //

PREPARED TALKS

Prepared talk/ speech/ presentation is that one whose topic, time, venue and the audience are already known to the speaker/ presenter. There are essentially two steps that should be followed prior to deliver a prepared talk/ presentation;

1. Develop your objectives
2. Analyze your audience. In preparation, one must identify the values, needs and constraints of the attendees and the level of knowledge of the audience.

Example

A CEO of an organization who has to address the annual meeting of all the stakeholders is an example of prepared talk/ presentation.

Process for prepared talks/ Presentation

Following steps should be followed for prepared talks/ presentations.

(i) Main Ideas and Notes Cards

Brainstorm main ideas and write on the cards. Use one idea per card.

An iceberg is an excellent metaphor for a good speech or presentation. Most of an iceberg lies under water. Thus, we have the expression, "the tip of the iceberg". The speech or presentation is like the tip of an iceberg because that is what the audience sees. What the audience doesn't see – the preparation – is like part of the iceberg beneath the water.

(ii) Stating the sub-points

State the sub-points. There should be 2-5 sub points in the presentation. Be specific using explanations, data and evidence to back up your points.

(iii) Highlighting the importance

State the usefulness of presentation. Specifically state the benefits before and at the end of the body of your presentation.

(iv) Handouts

Develop handouts. Handouts should reinforce important points, summarize action items and include supporting data.

(v) Visual Aids

Develop visual aids (PowerPoint slides, charts and graphs). Visual aids should be used to focus the attention of your audience, reinforce the verbal message and to stimulate interest.

(vi) Developing the Introduction

Provide background and valuable information. Introduce yourself if you are not introduced to your audience.

(vii) Organization of ideas

Organize your ideas as the talk starts from introduction leading to its end. Include supporting details just after the introduction.

(viii) Conclusion

The conclusion should be persuasive. At this step, each and every question of the audience should be answered up to their satisfaction.

UNPREPARED TALK

An unprepared/ impromptu speech/ presentation is one when speaker/ presenter is asked to speak in public without prior notice or preparation.

Examples

A few examples of this talk/ presentation are given below;

- Introducing oneself at social events.
- Filling in for a late speaker.
- Speaking on the occasion of a party/ celebration for vote of thanks etc.
- Say a goodbye speech to a departing employee/ colleague.
- Being referred in the middle of a presentation for input.

Techniques for effective Impromptu/ Unprepared Speech/ Oral Presentation

The following techniques can help in this regard;

- Give yourself time to prepare.
- Rise slowly from your chair and walk slowly to the lectern (or stand behind and away from your chair). Use this time to collect your thoughts and decide on the purpose and plan of your speech.
- Think about the opening sentence.
- Look around at audience and feel relaxed.
- Don't slump, fidget, grasp the lectern and don't put hands in your pockets.
- Speak and act in a confident manner.
- Deliver slowly.
- Maintain good eye-contact with the audience.
- Be brief and to the point.
- Don't ramble or say too much on the subject.
- Speak at the audience's level.

Advantages

- The speaker is spontaneous as he/ she says what he/ she feels, not what ought to say.
- Speaker gets a chance to express his/ her thoughts irrespective of what participants think or say about that specific topic.
- The speaker is natural in delivery because he/ she does not get enough time for preparation.

Disadvantages

- The speaker may have difficulty in connection with thinking of what to say or formulating the ideas once he/ she gets up to speak.
- The speech may lack details and supporting information.
- If the participants are passive and do not ask questions to guide the speaker, he/she may overlook some important content.
- This talk is rarely appropriate for occasions which require more reasoned discourse with supporting ideas.

Tips for oral presentation skills

- (i) If you are allowed to have a note card, write short notes in point form.
- (ii) Use formal language as far as possible.
- (iii) Use short and simple sentences to express your ideas clearly.
- (iv) Pause from time to time. Do not speak too quickly.
- (v) Speak at the right volume.
- (vi) Practise your presentation.
- (vii) Look at the people who are listening to you.

- (viii) Do not use slang, jargon, acronyms, or technical terms without explanation.

Starting Sentences

- (a) I'm going to talk about ...
- (b) I'd like to talk about ...
- (c) The main focus of this presentation is ...

Oral presentation skills are related with prepared and unprepared talks.

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Ten Simple Rules for Making Good Oral Presentations

Clear and logical delivery of your ideas and scientific results is an important component of a successful scientific career. Presentations encourage broader dissemination of your work and highlight work that may not receive attention in written form. Dr. Philip E. Bourne is a professor in the Department of Pharmacology, University of California San Diego, La Jolla, California. This article condenses his excellent list of rules for making a good oral presentation.

1. Talk to the Audience

Know your audience – their backgrounds and knowledge level of the material you are presenting and what they are hoping to get out of the presentation. Deliver what the audience wants to hear.

2. Less is More

Your knowledge of the subject is best expressed through a clear and concise presentation that is provocative and leads to a dialog during the question-and-answer session when the audience becomes active participants. At that point, your knowledge of the material will likely become clear.

3. Talk Only When You Have Something to Say

Remember the audience's time is precious and should not be abused by presentation of uninteresting preliminary material.

4. Make the Take-Home Message Persistent

A good rule of thumb is this: if you ask a member of the audience a week later about your presentation, he or she should be able to remember three points. If these are the key points you were trying to get across, you have done a good job. If they can remember any three points, but not the key points, then your emphasis was wrong. It is obvious what it means if they cannot recall three points!

5. Be Logical

Think of the presentation as a story. There is a logical flow—a clear beginning, middle, and an end. You set the stage (beginning), you tell the story (middle), and you have a big finish (the end) where the take-home message is clearly understood.

6. Treat the Floor as a Stage

Presentations should be entertaining, but do not overdo it and do know your limits. If you are not humorous by nature, do not try and be humorous. If you are not good at telling anecdotes, do not try and tell anecdotes, and so on. A good entertainer will captivate the audience and improve his or her chances of following Rule 4.

7. Practice and Time Your Presentation

The more you practice, the less likely you will be to go off on tangents. The more presentations you give, the better you are going to get. An important talk should not be given for the first time to an audience of peers. You should have delivered it to your research collaborators who will be kinder and gentler but still point out obvious discrepancies. Even more important, when you give the presentation, stick to what you practice.

8. Use Visuals Sparingly but Effectively

If you have more than one visual for each minute you are talking, you have too many and you will run over time. Obviously some visuals are quick, others take time to get the

message across. Avoid reading the visual unless you wish to emphasize the point explicitly. The visual should support what you are saying either for emphasis or with data to prove the verbal point. Finally, do not overload the visual. Make the points few and clear.

9. Review Audio and/or Video of Your Presentations

There is nothing more effective than listening to, or listening to and viewing, a presentation you have made. Seeing what is wrong is easy, correcting it the next time around is not. Work hard on breaking bad habits; it is important.

Summary

Even if it isn't a specific requirement, it is good practice to engage the audience and/or to have them interact during your presentation. In many oral presentation assessments you will be allowed or required to use visual aids, such as slides, images or props, to add an interesting feature and engage the audience. Keep your visual aids clear and to the point, and ensure that they are easily readable by your audience. Once you have completed writing your presentation - remember, this needs to sound like spoken language, not written language! - and have finalized your visual aids, it is time to practice the presentation. The fundamentals of public speaking remain the same in any context, be it classroom, conference, parliament or crowded city square. Good public speakers use simple and clear language to communicate complex points. They pause when they speak, and they deliver their message with confidence derived from their knowledge and preparation. A presentation is not a dry list of disconnected facts. Like lab reports or essays, it makes a specific point. Start by asking yourself "So What?" Determine the most important point you wish to make and identify why it is important. Plan your presentation to suit your audience. Consider their familiarity with the subject and their purpose for listening to your presentation. Classmates will likely have some background on the topic, and because they are keenly aware that they will

eventually present to you, they are usually quite generous in their reception of your talk. A logical structure supports a clear and focused message, and it stops you from leaping from idea to idea, which can make it difficult for your audience to understand your talk.

Activities

Activity 1:

Divide the topic of your presentation into subtopics, and allocate one to each group member. Doing this will ensure that the workload is evenly shared and that everyone takes part in the assessment.

Activity 2:

Rehearse together as a group. Although it may seem easy for each group member to go off and cover their own section alone, not having regular group meetings or rehearsals will cause your presentation to appear disjointed.

Activity 3:

Ensure the presentation is consistent by using a consistent style for your visual aids. If the visual aids your group uses are not consistent in format, colour and font styles, it will be clear to the marker that you have not been working as a team.

Activity 4:

Use a cloud-based service or platform to create your presentation. Most cloud-based services and platforms have functions that allow you to work on materials remotely from one another.

Activity 5:

Review the subject outline. Look for all relevant detail that you will need to understand the requirements of the task, including when it is due, the weight of the assessment, and the length of time you have to present. Review the assessment criteria. What are you are being assessed on?

Activity 6:

Analyse the task. Determine the purpose of the presentation. Do you need to answer a specific question?

Activity 7:

Consider the audience. What are their expectations of your content and delivery?

Activity 8:

Brainstorm. Map out everything you already know about the topic. Write out any ideas you can use to interact with the audience, or engage them, and jot down what questions, explanations and information you want the audience to be provided with.

Activity 9:

Do the research. Find relevant material, take notes, and remember to keep the references you used.

Activity 10:

Organise your ideas. Create a logical presentation so the information flows well.

Activity 11:

Pay attention to the language you are using. Presentations should be delivered in spoken or conversational language rather than written language. Spoken language is much easier for your audience to follow.

EXERCISES

LONG QUESTIONS

- Q1. Elaborate the introduction of oral presentations.
- Q2. Elucidate the Oral Presentations.
- Q3. What do you know about prepared talks, describe it.
- Q4. Describe simple rules for making good oral presentations.

Q5. Elucidate the summary of oral presentations.

SHORT QUESTIONS

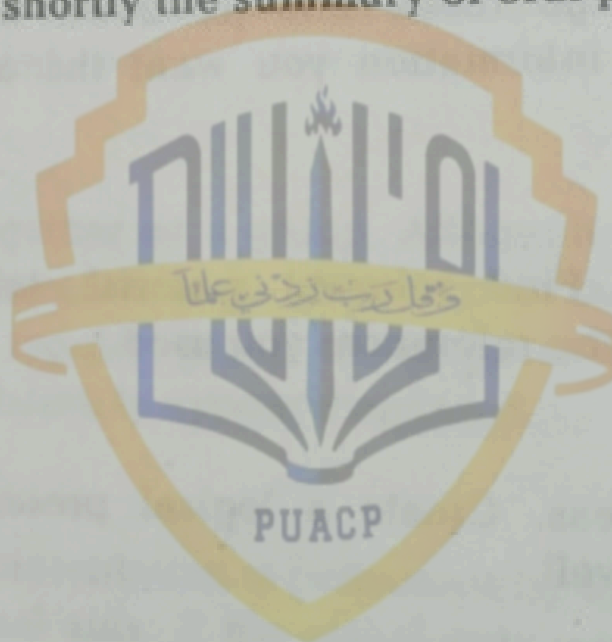
Q1. Describe shortly the introduction of oral presentations.

Q2. Describe shortly the Oral Presentations.

Q3. What do you know about prepared talks, describe it shortly.

Q4. Describe shortly simple rules for making good oral presentations.

Q5. Describe shortly the summary of oral presentations.



Chapter 2

Preparing for Interviews (Scholarship, Job, Placement for Internship, etc.)

Student's Learning Outcomes:

After completing this chapter, the students will be able to;

- Briefly introduce yourself: Although the question is open-ended and constitutes a broad, variable element to it, refrain from offering a general, universal answer.
- You must revert concentrating on attributes, experiences, or features that stand out, and are pertinent.
- Your pitch should be clean, and clear.
- Tell us about your role model: You need to be very specific, and honest about your role model.
- Your role model can be a public figure, a family member, a friend, or your preschool teacher.
- You must possess a strong comprehension of your admiration of your role model.
- Your choice of influence speaks volumes on your perspective of life, and the values you withhold.
- Tell us about your proudest achievement
- Brief us on the academic and co-curricular activities during your student life.

Introduction

A job interview is a conversation which occurs between a potential employer and a job applicant. During the job interview, the employer has the opportunity to appraise

applicant's qualifications, appearance and general fitness for the job the job available and advertised. There are three main types of interview, such as one-to-one interview, panel interview and competency interview. In one-to-one interview, candidates are interviewed by just one person (usually the boss!) and it's a simple question and answer session. In panel interview, this is where candidates are interviewed by more than one person at a time in the shape of a panel. In panel, different persons are professionally specialists in the different fields of the job. **Competency interview** is the most advanced interview type. In this type, interviewees are tested on different situations, e.g. 'tell me about a time when you showed good teamwork'.

JOB INTERVIEW

A job interview is a process in which a potential employee is evaluated by an employer for prospective employment in their company, organization or firm or office. During this process, the employer hopes to determine whether or not the applicant is suitable for the role. A job interview typically precedes the hiring decision, and is used to evaluate the candidate. The interview is usually preceded by the evaluation of submitted resumes/ C.Vs. from interested candidates, then selecting a small number of candidates for interviews. The job interview is considered one of the most useful tools for evaluating potential employees. The job interview is quite challenging. Interviewee is expected to answer difficult and unseen questions. Chances of success depend upon the preparation and delivery during the interview process.

PREPARATION FOR JOB/ EMPLOYMENT INTERVIEW

There are many ways to prepare for an interview. Following guidelines will help you in interview preparation.

(a) Job Analysis

An important part of interview preparation is to take the time to analyze the job posting. Know about the skills.

knowledge, and professional and personal qualities that are needed by the employer and critical for success in the job.

(i) Information about the Company/ Organization/ Department

Before attending a job interview, it's important to find out as much as you can about not only the job, but also the company/ organization/ department. It will help you prepare to answer interview questions about the company organization/ department. For a concise understanding of this, check out the relevant website, specifically the "About Us" page etc.

(ii) Practice Interviewing

Practice interviewing with a friend or family member ahead of time, and it will be much easier when you're actually in a job interview. Try to conduct the practice interview in the same format as the real interview. For example, if it is a phone interview, ask a friend to call you to practice answering questions over the phone. If it is a panel interview, ask a couple of friends to pretend to be a panel. If you are going to be interviewed virtually, make your mind for the technology in use, review common job interview questions and answers.

(iii) Physical Appearance

Regardless of the type of job you're interviewing for, that first impression should be a great one. When dressing for an interview for a professional position, dress accordingly. The dress should be neat and tidy with proper haircut.

(iv) Practice Interview Manners

Proper interview manners are important. Practice to greet your interviewer or interview panel etc. in polite, pleasant, and enthusiastic way.

(v) Going through the submitted resume/ C.V.

Before attending the interview, go through your resume/ C.V. that you submitted for applying for this job. Be mentally prepared to answer any question relating to the content in your

resume or C.V. The resume or C.V. are very much present before the interviewer or interview panel etc.

Sample of Interview Questions

- What aspect attracted you to this job?
- What makes you think that you are the right candidate for this job?
- Please introduce yourself.
- Tell about your interests.
- What are your strengths?
- What are your **weaknesses**?
- How do you see your career evolving here?
- What **salary** do you expect?

Questions About Employers and Jobs

1. Why did you leave your last job?
2. Why did you apply for this job opening?
3. Why did you choose your particular field of work?
4. What are the **disadvantages** of your chosen field?
5. What do you know about our company?
6. What do you think about how this industry operates today?
7. Why do you think you would like this particular type of job?

Questions About Work Experience and Expectations

8. What was your biggest failure?
9. What is your biggest weakness?
10. Describe an experience in which you learned from one of your mistakes.

12. What do you think determines a person's progress in a good organization?
13. What have you done that shows initiative and willingness to work?
14. Why should we hire you?

Questions About Work Habits

15. Do you prefer working with others or by yourself?
16. What type of boss do you prefer?
17. Have you ever had any difficulty getting along with colleagues or supervisors? With instructors? With other students?
18. What would you do if you were given an unrealistic deadline for a task or project?
19. How do you feel about overtime work?
20. How do you handle stress or pressure on the job?

MAKING A GOOD IMPRESSION ON THE INTERVIEWER

Following factors play role in making a good impression on the interviewer;

(i) Proper Interview Attire

Always dress appropriately for an interview so you make the best first impression on the interviewer.

(ii) Reviewing the scope of job

Know as much as you can about the job applied for. Review the scope of the job and know what the employer is looking for in the person they hire. Also, keep the points in your mind written in cover letter of your application and resume/ C.V. that you sent to the employer, so you are clear about what you can offer the employer.

(iii) Preparation for expected questions

Make a list of the expected questions to be asked in the interview. Know the best answers of these questions. Review the interview questions that employers most frequently ask from the candidate.

(iv) Check out the interviewer on LinkedIn

Spare some time and check out the interviewer on LinkedIn if you can find them. That will give you a sense of the person you'll be meeting with, as well as their career path and tenure with the company/ organization/ department.

(i) Improving Communication Skills

The candidate should improve the communication skills such as listening, speaking, reading, and writing before appearing in the interview.

(ii) Clarity about the career objective

The candidate should be clear about his/ her goals and aspirations that he/ she wants to pursue in career life. He/ she must be clear whether his/ her background and aptitude matches with career objectives.

(iii) Showing enthusiasm

Greet the interviewer and shake hands with enthusiasm and passion. If the interviewer or members of the interview panel do not extend hand for shaking with you, then do not try to shake hands. Show your excitement for availing this opportunity.

(iv) Speaking clearly and politely

The candidate must speak clearly, correctly, and politely, whatever answer he/ she gives. If she or he has to comment on his/ her former employer. He should avoid passing the derogatory/ disparaging remarks. Such disparaging remarks exert negative impression on the prospective employer.

(v) Expression of leadership/ management skills

The candidate should express his/ her ability to plan, motivate, organize, inspire, manage and lead the colleagues in that organization to achieve the organizational goal.

(vi) Expressing views regarding suitability for the job

Be specific and show the employer why and how you are the most suitable candidate for this post.

(vii) Conveying your value to the organization

- (a) If you encounter a potentially discriminatory question, decide how you want to respond before you say anything.
- (b) When you have the opportunity, ask questions from the list you've prepared; remember that interviewers expect you to ask questions.
- (c) Never answer a question before the interviewer finishes asking it.
- (d) Let the interviewer lead the conversation.
- (e) Don't limit yourself to simple yes or no answer, expand the answer to show your knowledge of the company (but don't ramble on).
- (f) Listen carefully to the interviewer and watch for nonverbal signals.

(viii) Strong Closing

- (a) If you receive an offer and aren't ready to decide, it's entirely appropriate to ask for time to think about it.
- (b) End with a warm smile and a handshake and thank the interviewer for meeting with you.
- (c) Watch and listen for signs that the interview is about to end.
- (d) Don't bring up salary but be prepared to discuss it if the interviewer raises the subject.

- (e) Quickly evaluate how well you've done and correct any misperceptions the interviewee might have.

INTERVIEW FOR INTERNSHIP

An **internship** is an opportunity for a student or trainee to gain valuable career experience by working within an organization/ department. Internships are an excellent way for one to gain real world experience, network with potential future coworkers and managers. Some salary is paid against it.

Preparation for Interview for Internship

The candidate should prepare for this interview keeping in mind the answers to the questions usually asked during this interview. Generally, questions around the knowledge requirements for the **internship** job can be answered by reviewing your **internship** resume as they refer directly to your qualifications and **training** and whatever work experience you have. Answering **these** questions confidently and professionally ensures you stand out as an impressive internship job candidate. Some **common** questions are given below;

- (i) Why did you choose this field?
- (ii) What do you hope to gain from this internship?
- (iii) What are your long-term career goals and how do you plan to achieve them?
- (iv) What do you expect regarding salary?
- (v) Do you currently attend any courses? If so, what days and hours are you available to work?
- (vi) Which programmes can you operate on computer?

Describe your ability, in your interview answer for the following;

- (a) To be proactive
- (b) To take imaginative steps to overcome obstacles
- (c) To generate new ideas

- (d) To take advantage of opportunities
- (e) To do more than required

Remember

Internship candidates generally lack professional experiences, so, internship interview questions will focus on the necessary competencies or behaviors for the position rather than work-related questions.

Reasons for failure in interview

Following reasons lead to failure in interview;

1. Poor Preparation

Poor preparation is the main cause of failure in interview. Due to poor preparation, the candidates cannot answer the relevant questions.

2. Displaying a Negative Attitude

Talking negatively about a previous company/ organization/ department, manager or coworker is the cause of failure in interview. Even if the candidate has legitimate reasons for showing complaint towards a previous employer, such as not receiving pay for overtime or having been skipped over for promotions, candidate should not show this attitude in the interview. Hiring managers/ firms/ companies want to see how you can overcome adversity, rising above and moving on past situations.

3. Lack of Enthusiasm

A lack of enthusiasm reflected through the body language, eye-contact and the tone of the voice of the candidate exerts negative impression on the interviewer and leads to the failure in interview.

4. Improper Behavior

Being rude to the receptionist, leaving the cell phone on, shaking hands too weakly or too strong, sitting before invited

by the interviewer, chewing gum, playing with your pen or hair are the signs of improper behavior for the interviewer.

5. Casual Look

Inappropriate dress, smelling like a cigarette, wearing sunglasses and using too much perfume etc. show casual look of the candidate. The interviewer from the casual look of the candidate guesses that the candidate is not serious for the job.

6. Arriving too late

Being late to an interview directly gives the impression that the candidate is irresponsible and not fit for the job.

7. Too long or incomplete CV

Candidates' too long CV or incomplete CV poses problems in the interview. As the employers/ interviewers have the CV in front of them in the interview. In case of incomplete or too long C.V., many questions will not be answered properly by the candidate in context of this CV.

8. Poor knowledge about the company

Candidates often fail in job interviews because they don't have proper information about the company or the job they are applying to.

9. Showing boredom

Yawning or not paying attention to the interviewer is perceived as the candidate is not interested in being there and in the job also.

10. Improper Handshake

Non-verbal communication is key to interview success. One of the very first examples of this form of communication a candidate can give is the handshake. If the interviewer extends hand for shaking with the candidate and the candidate either shakes hand poorly or too strongly, it will show lack of confidence on his or her part. It will cause negative impression on the interviewer.

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11. Taking it too personally

Sometimes, recruiters will make the candidate feel uncomfortable asking tricky questions to test his/ her ability to act under pressure. If the candidate becomes overly aggressive or uncomfortable, it gives a sign that the candidate is unfit to work under pressure. This impression leads to failure in interview.

INTERVIEW FOR SCHOLARSHIP

Earning a scholarship is a golden opportunity for everyone, irrespective of their caste, creed, or economic status. One has to prepare for this interview quite seriously because he/ she has to prove himself/ herself the most deserving student/ candidate. There is a generic set of common scholarship interview questions. Prepare for the interview regarding answers of the following questions/ remarks.

- (i) Briefly introduce yourself : Although the question is open-ended and constitutes a broad, variable element to it, refrain from offering a general, universal answer. You must revert concentrating on attributes, experiences, or features that stand out, and are pertinent. Your pitch should be clean, and clear.
- (ii) Tells us about your greatest strength and weakness?
- (iii) Why should we select you for this scholarship?
- (iv) What are your career goals?
- (v) Tell us about your role model: You need to be very specific, and honest about your role model. Your role model can be a public figure, a family member, a friend, or your pre-school teacher. You must possess a strong comprehension of your admiration of your role model. Your choice of influence speaks volumes on your perspective of life, and the values you withhold.
- (vi) Point out the mistake you have learned from?
- (vii) What made you choose this institution?

- (viii) Tell us about your proudest achievement
- (ix) Brief us on the academic and co-curricular activities during your student life
- (x) Can you tell us about your favorite hobby?
- (xi) What is your ambition in life?
- (xii) How will you utilize the scholarship money?
- (xiii) Can you tell us about an impacting experience or class you've had in school?
- (xiv) Brief us about a time when you overcame adversity
- (xv) State your favorite **subject**: For this question, you need to support your answer on why do you like the particular **subject**. The jury wants to evaluate your learning **methodology** and your **passion**. Refrain from provisioning answers that concentrate on the grades for that **subject**.

Effective Tips for the best preparation

- (i) Come prepared from **beforehand**
- (ii) Be analytical **while** answering. Keep in mind that every institution or **university** will try to procure the best of students, so being informative can only help you on your way to success.
- (iii) Speak from the heart at all points
- (iv) When you come to the interview, you must let your words come straight from the heart. You must reflect your true personality.
- (v) Show passion for your subject. When speaking in the course of the interview, ensure that your answers are with the passion for the subject.
- (vi) Be very confident, no matter what. When appearing for an interview, confidence is the key. Appearing for a scholarship interview is

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Effective Tips for the best preparation

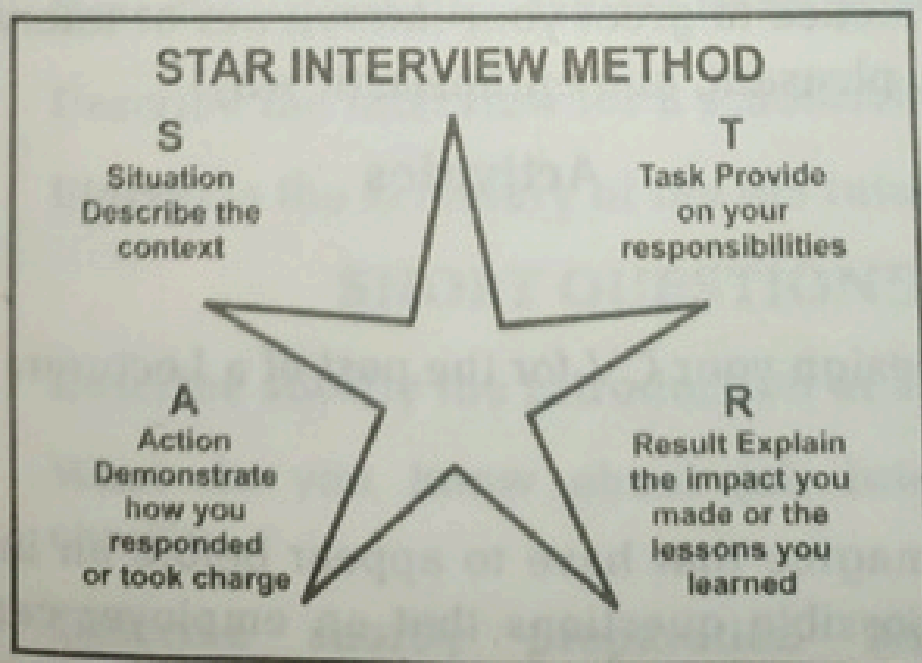
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- (iv) When you come to the interview, you must let your words come straight from the heart. You must reflect your true personality.
- (v) Show passion for your subject. When speaking in the course of the interview, ensure that your answers are with the passion for the subject.
- (vi) Be very confident, no matter what. When appearing for an interview, confidence is the key. Appearing for a scholarship interview is no exception either.

- (vii) Ask your family or friends for a mock interview. This helps you in rectifying your mistakes, gain confidence and overcome anxiety on such occasions. Go through all the common questions asked in a scholarship interview.

The STAR Interview Response Method

The STAR interview response method is a way of answering behavioral interview questions. This strategy works when you are asked about your response to past experience. It is advisable to go through instances of your past experience that show aspects of your personal achievements. Use STAR approach while answering such questions. STAR stands for situation, task, action, result.

1. **Situation:** You should give relevant background information moving from general to specific information experience relating to the job.
2. **TASK:** Give the details of the task your team accomplished and give details about your role in the completion of the task.
3. **Action:** Explain how you did it and how this required you to employ your personal skills.
4. **Result:** Give details of the result achieved and also show their relationship with your actions and decisions.



Summary

An important part of interview preparation is to take the time to analyze the job posting. Know about the skills, knowledge, and professional and personal qualities that are needed by the employer and critical for success in the job.

Before attending a job interview, it's important to find out as much as you can about not only the job, but also the company/ organization/ department. It will help you prepare to answer interview questions about the company organization/ department. For a concise understanding of this, check out the relevant website, specifically the "About Us" page etc. Practice interviewing with a friend or family member ahead of time, and it will be much easier when you're actually in a job interview. Try to conduct the practice interview in the same format as the real interview. For example, if it is a phone interview, ask a friend to call you to practice answering questions over the phone. If it is a panel interview, ask a couple of friends to pretend to be a panel. If you are going to be interviewed virtually, make your mind for the technology in use, review common job interview questions and answers. Regardless of the type of job you're interviewing for, that first impression should be a great one. When dressing for an interview for a professional position, dress accordingly. The dress should be neat and tidy with proper haircut. Proper interview manners are important. Practice to greet your interviewer or interview panel etc. in polite, pleasant, and enthusiastic way.

Activities

Activity 1:

Directions: Design your CV for the post of a Lecturer.

Activity 2:

Directions: Imagine that have to appear before an interviewer, write down possible questions that an employer can ask you based on your education, experience and interests.

PREPARING FOR INTERVIEWS

Activity 3:

Directions: Write a dialogue between a student and a professor regarding choice of job. The student has approached his/ her professor to seek advice if he/ she should join management group or Pakistan Police service after qualifying CSS exam.

Activity 4:

Make your resume and CV. This resume should be for the post of general manager in a private firm.

Activity 5:

Write a job application to the principal of M.A.O. College, Lahore for the post of lecturer in English and make your CV in this regard.

EXERCISES LONG QUESTIONS

- Q1. Elaborate the introduction of job interview.
- Q2. What do you know about job interview.
- Q3. Describe preparation for job/employment.
- Q4. Elucidate making a good impression on interview.
- Q5. Discuss the interview for internship.
- Q6. Describe reasons for failure in an interview.
- Q7. Describe the interview for a scholarship.
- Q8. Elucidate the summary of the job interview.

SHORT QUESTIONS

- Q1. Describe shortly the introduction of a job interview.
- Q2. What do you know about job interview describe it shortly.
- Q3. Describe shortly preparation for job/employment.

- Q4. Elucidate making a good impression on interview.
- Q5. Discuss shortly the interview for internship.
- Q6. Describe shortly reasons for failure in an interview.
- Q7. Describe shortly the interview for a scholarship.
- Q8. Describe shortly the summary of the job interview.



Chapter 3

Writing Formal Letters

Student's Learning Outcomes:

After completing this chapter, the students will be able to;

- Contractions should not be used in a formal letter.
- Informal abbreviations should not be used in formal letters. The use of active verbs with the first person singular pronoun **must be limited**.
- Degree modifiers such as really and so are informal in nature. These **should be avoided**.
- Instead, use extremely, highly, and entirely etc.
- Most phrasal verbs are idiomatic in nature and hence their meaning cannot be guessed from their individual parts.
- The ordinary verbs should be used instead of phrasal verbs.
- Set phrases and idioms should be avoided as far as possible.

FORMAL LETTER

Introduction

A formal letter is one which is written where the relationship between the writer and the receiver is shown to be impersonal. The tone of such a letter is usually very polite, written for official or formal purposes (recommendation letter, an invitation letter, a complaint letter etc.). The writer does not risk familiarity by compromising the convention, even when the recipient is well known to the writer. Letter written to bring the

mistakes/ errors/ grievances to the notice of those who own the responsibilities for them is called *claim or complaint letter*. It is generally used when another way of conveying the complaint is a failure like a phone, email, etc.

Writing Formal Letters

Definition of a Formal Letter

Formal Letters also called Business Letters or Professional Letters are letters that are written in a strict and specific format. Formal letters are naturally much more formal in style than informal/friendly letters. Formal letters can be written for a number of reasons such as:

- to express your concerns in the professional setup
- to provide official information across your workplace
- to enter proofs in a legal document
- to the Editor of a newspaper addressing the problem faced by various groups of people in different areas or

Structure of a Formal Letter

In order to be able to write a formal letter, you have to first understand the reason behind the letter. As far as formal letters are concerned, the structure of the letter changes depending on the type of letter. There are certain rules to be followed in order to draft a formal letter. Every sentence should be well thought out and laid down in such a way that the message you want to convey should be precise and clear to the reader.

Types of Formal Letters

There are different types of formal letters, as discussed and they can generally be labelled under the following terms:

- Business Letters
- Letters of Application
- Letters to Newspapers

Business Letters

Business letters should be terse, clear and to the point. There is no room for any kind of stories in a business letter. Before you start to write a business letter, there are a few things you should keep in mind.

- Use simple, everyday language to convey the message clearly instead of using flamboyant and overemphatic vocabulary.
- Never use jargon that is commonly used in business when you write a business letter.
- Avoid using abbreviations as much as possible.
- The modes of address vary according to the type of letter and the receiver.
- Clear and exact descriptions of the articles necessary with the expected quality and quantity should be listed with utmost care when you write a letter to order goods.
- When replying to a business letter, always quote the date of the letter you are responding to and the number of references (if any).

Formal/Business letters include letters from an employer to the employees and vice versa, letters to order and replace goods, letters of serious concern to an officer of higher rank, letters of complaint, etc.

Letters of Application

Letters of Application usually consist of letters applying for employment. Before and after you write a letter of application, make sure you check for the following:

- Always start with a short introduction stating whether the applicant is writing in response to a reference from an advertisement found online or in the newspaper.
- State the age, education and experience of the applicant.

- Provide the employer with a genuine expression of the applicant's earnestness in taking up the job in the respective company.
- Also, furnish references so that the employer can gather an idea of the kind of employee you would be.

Letters of Application should follow the format of formal/business letters.

Letters to Newspapers

Always address these letters to 'The Editor' and end with 'Yours faithfully'. Letters to the Editor are letters that express concerns that should be addressed to the higher authorities. These letters should be professional and authentic. No newspaper would publish anonymous letters, so make sure you are writing the letter for a cause and provide your name and address correctly.

Writing a Formal Letter – Parts of a Formal Letter

When writing a formal letter, always be respectful and conscious of your language, no matter what the subject of the letter might be. To write a formal letter, there are some points to be remembered.

1. Always start with the sender's address
2. This is followed by the date.
3. The receiver's address comes next. The receiver can be the name of the firm or the one who represents the firm.
4. The subject of the letter is very important. It is a statement of the purpose of the letter. It should be written in a single line.
5. The salutation can be Dear Sir/Ma'am. If it is a person you know well, you can address them by their name, 'Dear Shrinath'.
6. The body of the letter can be written in 3 paragraphs.

WRITING FORMAL LETTERS

- The first paragraph should be aimed at introducing yourself and stating the purpose of your letter.
 - The second paragraph should furnish all the information about the matter.
 - The third paragraph can be a concluding paragraph where you lay out your expectations regarding the matter.
7. To close the letter, you can use a complimentary closing like 'Yours faithfully', 'Yours sincerely' etc.
 8. Unlike informal letters, the signature should include your name (in block letters) and designation below your signature.

A letter to the editor of a daily newspaper complaining about the construction work on your road in the middle of monsoon season causing inconveniences to the people of your locality.

D- 1801, Neptune Society,

DS Marg, Lower Parel,

Lahore 400 008.

8/9/2022.

To,

The Editor-in-Chief,
Dawn,
Main Street,
Lahore 400 001.

Sir,

Subject: Construction work in our locality during monsoon season causing us difficulties.

Through the medium of your esteemed and respected daily, I wish to inform the municipal authorities of the difficulties the residents of my locality are facing due to the

construction and repair work currently happening in our area. Monsoon season has started a few days ago and is compounding our problems.

The repair work has been ongoing for five weeks now and is falling way behind schedule. And now with the current weather conditions, we are having persistent problems of water logging and flooding in our area. Another worry is about the accidents that may occur due to the debris lying around the road. Diseases caused due to waterlogging are another one of our concerns.

Therefore I wish to draw the attention of the concerned authorities with the help of your newspaper. Hopefully, you will be able to help us in drawing their attention and resolving this matter at the earliest.

Thanking You,

Your Sincerely,

“signature”

[Mr. XYZ]

Sections of Formal Letter

The letter includes: the heading, date, address of recipient, salutation, body, complimentary close and signature.

(i) Heading

Most professional correspondence is printed on a letterhead template. A letterhead contains the company/organization/ firm/ department's name, address and contact information. An individual may also create a letterhead that contains his/ her name and personal contact information.

(ii) Date

The date is the day the letter is sent. The most commonly used date format is: February 22nd, 2021. Do not abbreviate the month and always include all four digits of the year.

(iii) Address

This is the address of the recipient. If applicable, the first line in the address block should include the recipient's name

and title or title/ designation and the second line should state the recipient's company/ firm/ department/ office. The third and fourth lines are designated for the actual address.

(iv) Salutation

Different circumstances determine which salutation or greeting is most appropriate. Use "Dear" when the recipient's name or title is known. Examples include "Dear Mr. Ali" or "Dear Sales Manager" or "Chief Executive Officer" etc. When the name or title is unknown, use "To Whom It May Concern." Always punctuate the salutation of a formal letter with a colon instead of a comma.

(v) Body

The body is the longest part of a letter and is usually divided into three parts: introduction, main content and summary. The introductory paragraph states the purpose of the letter. The main content conveys all necessary detailed information and has no set length requirements. The last paragraph summarizes the information provided, restates the letter's intent and offers either instructions or an inquiry regarding follow-up correspondence etc.

(vi) Complimentary Close

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The complimentary close is a word or short phrase that basically means "goodbye." "Sincerely/ Truly" is the most common closing remark. Others include "cordially," "best wishes," and "best regards." The complimentary close can vary in degrees of formality. It is dependent upon the relationship between the sender and recipient.

(vii) Signature

In letters that are sent via email, the signature is simply the sender's name and title typed immediately below the complimentary close. When a letter is mailed, faxed or hand-delivered, however, there should be a large enough space below the closing and above the typed name and title for the sender to provide his/ her written signature.

Language of a Formal Letter

The language used in a formal letter must be appropriate in style and tone. The basic features of language of a formal letter are as following;

(i) No contractions

Contractions should not be used in a formal letter.

Example

Inappropriate

This isn't what we'd expect from a professional service.

Correct

This is not what we would expect from a professional service.

(ii) No use of abbreviations

Informal abbreviations should not be used in formal letters. For example, do not write info for information. However, abbreviations like BBC and RADAR etc. are perfectly acceptable.

(iii) Limiting the use of first person singular pronoun

The use of active verbs with the first person singular pronoun must be limited.

Example

Inappropriate

I will send you all the relevant information ASAP.

Appropriate

All the relevant information will be forwarded to you as soon as possible.

(iv) Avoiding informal degree modifiers

Degree modifiers such as really and so are informal in nature. These should be avoided. Instead, use extremely, highly, and entirely etc.

(v) Limiting the use of phrasal verbs

Most phrasal verbs are idiomatic in nature and hence their meaning cannot be guessed from their individual parts. The ordinary verbs should be used instead of phrasal verbs.

(vi) Avoiding set phrases and idioms

Set phrases and idioms should be avoided as far as possible.

Example

Inappropriate

He really gets on my nerves.

Appropriate

He irritates me.

COMPLAINT LETTER

Definition: Letter written to bring the mistakes/ errors/ grievances to the notice of those who must own the responsibilities for them is called claim or complaint letter. It is generally used when another way of conveying the complaint is a failure like a phone, email, etc.

Situations in which Complaint Letter is written

- (a) A wrong delivery of goods
- (b) Shipment of obsolete, poor quality or underweight goods
- (c) Faulty packing of goods
- (d) Delivery of goods after the specified date
- (e) Supply of damaged goods
- (f) Any grievance related with the life issues like supply of contaminated water from municipal tube wells or heaps of garbage in the streets etc.

Sample of Letter of Complaint

City ABC.

March 20th, 2021

To

Managing Director,

Dear Sir/Madam,

Asslam.o.Aalaikum,

On March 10th, 2021 I placed an order for an iron and received it on march 15th, 2021. I have detected that the supplied item has the following problem;

(a) _____ (b) _____

(c) _____

I am rejecting the supplied item, returning it to you and request that you should refund the sum paid to you including my parcel charges. If you don't refund it, then replace it with a new non-defective unit. My demand is also in the light of the warranty card issued signed by you.

Dear Sir/ Madam! Please address my complaint at the earliest. In case of failure, I will move to consumer court for the remedy.

Thanks,

Yours faithfully,

XYZ

Address _____

Contact No. _____

Samples of a Formal Letter

OFFICIAL LETTER

Telephone No. of the sender _____

No. of the letter _____

Letter head _____

Government of the Punjab

Name of the Department/Wing _____

Date including the place of issue. _____

From: _____

Name and designation of the sender.

To: _____

Designation and address of the addressee.

Subject: _____

Sir/Madam,

I am directed to _____ (when purporting to issue under
directions from Government).

2. I have the pleasure to PUAC (when not purporting to
issue under directions from Government)

Your obedient servant.
Signature and designation
of the sender

Particulars of document attached, if any. _____

ENDORSEMENT

No. _____ Date _____

A copy is forwarded to: _____

Signature and designation
of the sender.

Particulars of documents attached, if any.

**Letter Addressed To Non-Officials or Groups of
Individuals**

Telephone No. of the sender

No. of the letter

Letter head

Government of the Punjab

Name of the Department/Wing

Date including the place of issue.

From:

Name and designation of the sender.

To:

Name, designation and address of the addressee.

Subject: _____

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am directed to _____ (when purporting to issue under
directions from Government).

2. I have the pleasure to _____ (when not purporting to
issue under directions from Government)

Your truly,
Signature and designation
of the sender

Particulars of document attached, if any.



No. DO (MAE) / PESRP / SED / 2022
PROGRAM MONITORING &
IMPLEMENTATION UNIT
PUNJAB EDUCATION SECTOR
REFORM PROGRAM

Dated Lahore the 29th March, 2022

To

The Regional General Manager PEMRA,
(Lahore. Muttan. Gujranwala. Faisalabad. Sargodha.
Islamabad).
Pakistan Electronic Media Regulatory Authority.
Government of Pakistan.

SUBJECT: AIRING OF INFORMATIVE TV COMMERCIAL
OF SCHOOL ENROLLMENT CAMPAIGN 2022

Kindly refer to the subject cited above.

2. School Education Department (SED) has initiated School Enrollment Drive 2021 in order to bring out-of-school children back to schools. The campaign will also contribute to improve attendance and retention of students as schools open after the second wave of COVID-19. As part of School Enrollment Drive, School Education Department is launching a mass media awareness campaign through print, electronic and digital media.

3. Mass media campaign will include an informative TV commercial to and community to send missed out, dropped out, never gone and out of school children to schools and to encourage them to continue their education. This TV commercial will be aired on national TV channels till 16th February. To ensure optimum transmission of the message, SED intends to air it through local cable channels across Punjab.

4. TV Commercial win be shared with District Education Authorities by PMIU so that the Deputy Commissioners can ensure its transmission through local cablenetworks for which the divisional and distnct administrations shall hold a meeting with thelocal cable operators. For successful implementation of this initiative, the cooparation of local cable operators is required.

5. In this regard, Regional General Managers PEMRA are requested to be in iaison with the Distnct Education Authorities to ensure all local cable operators air the TVC prepared by School Education Department.

6. Further necessary action may kindly be taken accordingly please

Aslam Baig
PROGRAM DIRECTOR
PMIU PESRP

cc:

- 1) PSO to Minister for School Education Department.
- 2) PS to Secretary. School Education Department.
- 3) The Director General Public Relations. Punjab. Lahore.

LETTER OF ADJUSTMENT

An Adjustment Letter is a formal correspondence from a company/ firm to a customer expressing that his/ her complaint has been received and the necessary course of action is being taken or is due to be taken. This letter for addressing the concerns of clients. In the course of transacting business with clients. Disputes arise commonly. These issues could be wrong deliveries, defects in the products that are delivered to the clients, defective equipment, or even an insufficient number of the items asked for. Upon receipt of the complaint, the company drafts yet another letter in the light of nature of complaints and terms and conditions of the business/ deal.

Sample of Letter of Adjustment

To

Marketing Manager

XYZ, Top Fabrics

Auriga Complex,

Main Market,

Gulberg, Lahore

Reference: Your complaint regarding [product] dated

Dear Sir/ Madam,

We thank you for your letter of [Date] along with/ sample of cloth for examination. The report that we have received just today shows that the consignment, forwarded to you was the wrong one containing damaged clothes. It was a mistake at the end of our dispatch team. We regret this mistake which caused you both mental agony, financial loss and inconvenience. We are managing the replacement as early as possible. Be sure about the quality and quantity of cloth now sent. Your dispatch charges are also being compensated for. We again regret the inconvenience to you and assure you that such mistakes will be avoided in future.

Yours faithfully

ABC

Sales Manager

Gift Textile Mills,

Faisalabad

Summary

A formal letter is one written in a formal and ceremonious language and follows a certain stipulated format. Such letters are written for official purposes to authorities, dignitaries, colleagues, seniors, etc and not to personal contacts, friends or

family. A number of conventions must be adhered to while drafting formal letters. So let us take a look at a sample format of a formal letter. As we said earlier, a formal letter must follow certain rules and conventions. Such a format helps in relaying the information in a professional way. It must be remembered that there are various such formats for formal letters that people follow. The one explained here is the one most commonly used for formal communication these days. The sender's address is usually put on the top right-hand corner of the page. The address should be complete and accurate in case the recipient of the letter wishes to get in touch with the sender for further communication. The sender's address is followed by the date just below it, i.e. on the right side of the page. This is the date on which the letter is being written. It is important in formal letters as they are often kept on record. After leaving some space we print the receiver's address on the left side of the page. Whether to write "To" above the address depends on the writer's preference. Make sure you write the official title/name/position etc of the receiver, as the first line of the address. This is where you greet the person you are addressing the letter to. Bear in mind that it is a formal letter, so the greeting must be respectful and not too personal. The general greetings used in formal letters are "Sir" or "Madam". If you know the name of the person the salutation may also be "Mr. XYZ" or "Ms. ABC". But remember you cannot address them only by their first name. It must be the full name or only their last name. After the salutation/greeting comes the subject of the letter. In the centre of the line write 'Subject' followed by a colon. Then we sum up the purpose of writing the letter in one line. This helps the receiver focus on the subject of the letter in one glance. This is the main content of the letter. It is either divided into three paras or two paras if the letter is briefer. The purpose of the letter should be made clear in the first paragraph itself. The tone of the content should be formal. Do not use any flowery language. Another point to keep in mind is that the letter should be concise and to the point. And always be respectful and considerate in your language, no matter the

subject of your letter. At the end of your letter, we write a complimentary closing. The words "Yours Faithfully" or "Yours Sincerely" are printed on the right side of the paper. Generally, we use the latter if the writer knows the name of the person. Here finally you sign your name. And then write your name in block letters beneath the signature. This is how the recipient will know who is sending the letter.

Activities

Activity 1:

First, let's discuss some class activities you could do with your students. Logically, you need to begin with teaching the proper format. Students must be able to identify and define all the pieces of a letter, like the letterhead, address, date, greeting, body, closing and signature.

For this, you can distribute samples of business letters for students to practice identifying the parts. A more creative activity could be to make this into a sort of game or puzzle. Cut up the sample business letters to make the pieces of the puzzle. Then students can compete to put all the letters back together correctly.

Next, you want to move into the style and skill of the actual writing of the message. One activity for this could be to use the sample business letters with mistakes or errors. The students then should work to fix the problems. Eventually, get them to the point where they are revising the actual message in order to make it more persuasive or professional.

Lastly, relate the business letters to technology in the form of emails. Students can translate the sample letters to emails, creating their own subject lines. All these activities will help to teach the basics about business letters.

Activity 2: Prompts:

Once you feel your students have enough background on the structure of a business letter, you can move into writing

completely new letters. The key with these is to be creative and relate to real world situations. Some students might have already had to deal with businesses due to faulty products or applying for jobs. If students can see the value in the task, then they will put much more effort into writing the letter. Here is a list of some creative writing prompts for business letters.

Activity3:

Reading the Mail: Objective: Read a friendly letter and identify the parts.

Materials: Friendly letters for your students written by family members/school personnel/etc., colored pencils

- Preparation: Prior to this lesson, arrange for each of your students to receive a friendly letter. You might ask parents to write their child a letter, or members of the school community, etc.
- Give each student a friendly letter.
- As a class, review the elements of a friendly letter one by one. As you review each element, students look at their letters and identify that element in their letter.
- Students highlight that element with a designated color, then share the element with a partner.
- Repeat with each element of the friendly letter.
- For example:
 - Friendly letters begin with a date.
 - Students find the date, highlight it in blue, and share it with a partner.
 - Friendly letters contain a salutation.
 - Students find the salutation, highlight it in yellow, and share it with a partner.
 - Compare different types of salutations students find in their letters. Make a list on the board.
 - Etc.

WRITING FORMAL LETTERS

Activity 4:

Directions: Draft a reply in the capacity of Project Manager to the letter of complaint that your firm received regarding poor quality of stationery items supplied to a customer.

Activity 5:

Directions: Draft a letter to the Chief Executive Officer of LESCO, Lahore for replacing or repair of the recently newly installed electric meter of your house due to its inaccurate speed.

Activity 6:

Directions: Imagine that you received a camera at the head office of the company where you are employed as Marketing Executive regarding its poor working, but after the expiry of the warranty card. Draft a Letter of Adjustment accordingly.

EXERCISES

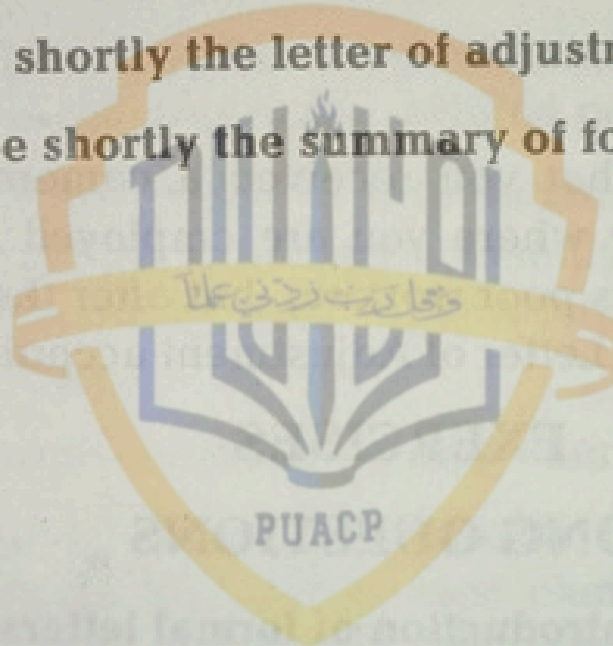
LONG QUESTIONS

- Q1. Elaborate the introduction of formal letters.
- Q2. Elucidate the writing formal letters.
- Q3. Discuss the types of formal letters.
- Q4. Write a letter to the editor of a daily newspaper complaining about the construction work on your road in the middle of monsoon season causing inconveniences to the people of your locality.
- Q5. Put a light on the language of a formal letter.
- Q6. Discuss the complaint letter.
- Q7. Elaborate the letter of adjustment.
- Q8. Elucidate the summary of formal letter writing.

SHORT QUESTIONS

- Q1. What is a formal letter?

- Q2.** What is the format of a formal letter?
- Q3.** How can I write a formal letter?
- Q4.** Describe shortly the introduction of formal letters.
- Q5.** Describe shortly the writing formal letters.
- Q6.** Discuss the types of formal letters.
- Q7.** Put a short light on the language of a formal letter.
- Q8.** Discuss briefly the complaint letter.
- Q9.** Discuss shortly the letter of adjustment.
- Q10.** Describe shortly the summary of formal letter writing.



Chapter 4

Writing Different Kinds of Applications (Leave, Job, Complaint, etc.)

Student's Learning Outcomes:

After completing this chapter, the students will be able to;

- Take care of the readability and white space in your letter.
- Make sure your points connect with each other. Don't include irrelevant information since an application is to be concise by format.
- Take care of grammatical and spelling errors.
- Be sure of the dates you are writing in the letter.

APPLICATIONS FOR LEAVE, JOB, COMPLAINT etc.

Introduction

A formal request or appeal (usually written and sometimes spoken) for employment, admission, help, funds and complaint etc. is called application. A job application is the most comprehensive tool used by employers when evaluating potential employees. Application regarding a complaint is addressed to the authority who is at the helm of affairs. In this application, complaint(s)/ grievances are highlighted and request is made for the redressal of these. Application for leave and its sanction is mandatory for the employees working in an organization before proceeding on leave. A good leave application can make things smooth between you and your boss. While writing a leave application for office, it is important to mention the subject and proper reason for leave. This leave

application can have various grounds such as to meet an emergency or sickness or some injury etc. The employees write this application to the competent authority which has the power/ authority to sanction such leave.

Writing Different Kinds of Application

We are all familiar with writing the application of leave of absence at least once in our lives. If you can't relate, there are countless other times application letters are written. It can be for a job, asking for permission to host a football competition on the school grounds, asking for a transfer certificate after your dad gets posted somewhere else, etc. Here, I will tell you how you will write a general application letter.

What is an Application Letter?

If you've been following, the letter you write when you request for something, ask permission for something or apply for something, is an application letter. It is usually a one-page letter. It can be written for domestic or professional purposes. It can also accompany documents sometimes, like job application letters. So to say, application letters encompass more than cover letters; they can be an inquiry and a request letter too.

TYPES OF APPLICATION LETTERS

Following this thread, application letters can be classified into 3 broad groups. They include:

1. Job Application Letter
2. Academic Application Letter
3. Personal Application Letter

Examples of job application letters include:

See cover letters

Examples of academic application letters include:

1. Application letter seeking permission

2. Scholarship application letter
3. Application for leave of absence/in advance
4. Application for a seat in the hostel
5. Application for a testimonial, etc.

Examples of personal application letters include:

1. Loan application letter
2. Rental application letter
3. Application letter for a deduction of fine
4. Application withdrawal letter
5. Internship application letter
6. Transfer application letter
7. Application letter for a travel grant, etc.

Note that these personal letters can be written person-to-person or person-to-business.

Steps on How to Write An Application Letter:

Like any other basic letter writing, the application letter starts with planning. Plan on the content, enquire about the recipient, think through about the details to include, keep things simple and short, and et voilà!

Let's break things down.

Suppose you are writing an application to your college professor for the retake of your Microeconomics exam. Here's how you draft your piece:

1. Start with the date.
2. Include the name of the professor, his post, department, and name of the university. Your professor can be an external or internal faculty. If he is an external faculty, mention this and the name of your university. If not, you

still should include it to make things more precise. Add his contact information.

3. Follow this up with the date. Proceed to the subject line. here, application for the retake on an exam is the subject.
4. In the first paragraph, introduce yourself. Mention your name, batch, and program, followed by the course name. Now state why you are writing, which is to apply for the retake of your Microeconomics exam.
5. Next paragraph should mention the reasons for you to skip the exam. Make sure they are valid grounds. If you had been sick, attach prescriptions or documents from the appointment. If you had been away for personal issues, give brief details of the event.
6. In the closing paragraph, ask him/her to excuse you on these grounds and to retake your exam and say how it will be beneficial to you.
7. Close with your details. Don't forget to add your contact information like the mailing ID here.

FORMAT OF APPLICATION REGARDING LEAVE

Sender's name

Designation in the office/ company and address

Date: February 25th, 2021

To

Receiver's Designation:

Office/ Company _____

Subject: Application for leave from [start date] to [end date]

Respected Mr. /Mrs.

I am writing this application to request for leave from office. Actually, I have to attend a family function at [name of the place]. For attending the same, I want leave from [start date] to [end date].

It is really important for me to attend this function, being a close relative of the family. After attending the function, I will be joining back the office on [date]. I have cleared all the priority tasks for the upcoming week. As for attending the function, I have to go to outstation, therefore, I will have to leave early on the evening of [date] to be in time at the railway platform.

Sir/ Madam! Please consider my leave application and approve the same for the **aforementioned** period. I shall be really grateful to you.

Yours Truly,

Signature

Name

FORMAT OF A JOB APPLICATION

PUACP

(i) Personal Information

This part of application includes the following:

- (a) Name, parentage and date of birth
- (b) Contact number and email
- (c) Permanent and temporary address/ correspondence address

(ii) Academic and Professional Qualification

This section should provide the names, addresses of the educational institutions that you attended and from where you obtained degrees/ certificates and diplomas etc. regarding academic and professional qualification. It should also give the

years of passing these examinations with your roll numbers, grades and years when you qualified.

(iii) Position

The position section refers to your desired job or position. In addition to the position title, list the desired salary requirements, the earliest date you could begin working for the company/ firm or department etc.

(iv) Work Experience

This section should contain your work experience with description of the nature of work, scales, salaries and duties performed thereby.

(v) References

In the references section, you provide the names, addresses and phone numbers of people who can testify your character and conduct etc.

(vi) Certification

The final part of the job application is the certification. In this section, you attest to the truthfulness of the information provided in the application and acknowledge that, if you are hired, falsifying information is grounds for termination. The final step is to sign and date the application.

SAMPLE FOR APPLICATION OF JOB

Dated: February 25th, 2021

To

Receiver's Designation:

Office/ Company

Subject: Application for appointment as

Respected Mr./Mrs.

Humbly, it is submitted that I am writing this application in response to your advertisement regarding above-cited

appointment that appeared in "The News" Lahore, dated February 15th, 2021.

First Paragraph

Second Paragraph

Third Paragraph

Sir/ Madam! Please consider my leave application favorably in the light of above submission and the resume/ CV attached. I assure you that I will deliver my services as per your requirement and satisfaction. I shall be really grateful to you.

Thanks in anticipation,

PUACP
Yours Truly,

Signature

Name

Address

SAMPLE OF AN APPLICATION REGARDING SOME COMPLAINT

Dated: February 25th, 2021

To

Receiver's Designation:

Office/ Company

Subject: Request for redressal of complaint regarding

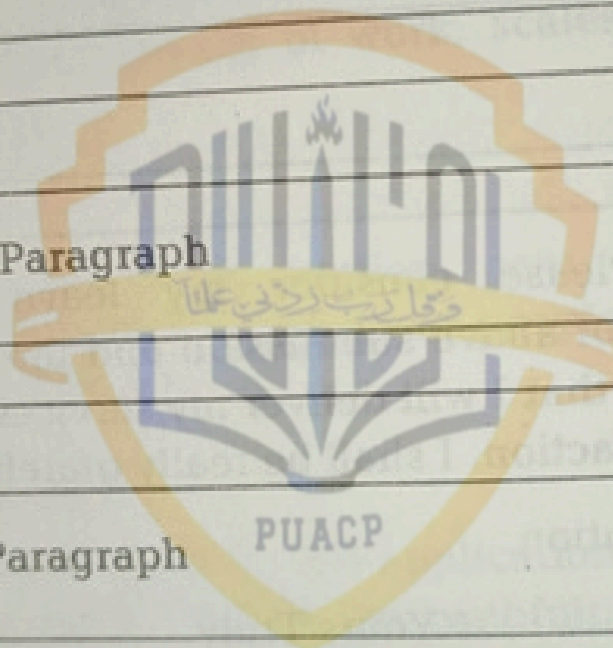
Respected Mr. /Mrs.

Humbly, it is submitted that I am writing this application regarding the following complaint/ issue.

First Paragraph

Second Paragraph

Third Paragraph



Sir/ Madam! Please consider my application favorably in the light of above submission. You are requested to highlight this issue in the national press and in your esteemed newspaper or resolve this issue _____.

With best regards,

Yours Truly,

Signature

Name

Summary

Write a letter for each application, tailored for the specific situation. Even if the ad calls only for a résumé, send a letter anyway. The letter makes a first impression, and it can direct the reader to notice key points of the résumé. Use standard letter format, with internal addresses (spell names correctly!) and salutations. Use specific names or at least position titles whenever possible (call the company or check its Website). Avoid the dated "Dear Sir and Madam." "To whom it may concern" is weak. You can use an "Attention" line or a "Subject" line instead of a salutation if you have to. Most application letters for entry-level jobs are one page in length—a substantial page rather than a **skimpy** one. Start strong and clear. For an advertised position, name the job and say where you saw the ad. For a speculative letter, name a specific function you can offer and relate it to something you know about the organization.

Use paragraph structure to lead your reader from one interpretive point to another. Refer to specific information in terms of examples for the points you're making, and mention that your résumé gives further evidence. End strongly by requesting an interview. It is now standard to say that you will call soon to set a time. Phrases like "thank you for your time" are unnecessary. Keep the reader's interests in mind. Your message is "you need me," not just "I want a job." Know enough about the organization or company to recognize what readers will be looking for. Then the focus of your documents will be where you fit and what you can contribute. This principle will also determine your choice of emphasis and even your wording (not "I have had four years experience" but "My experience will help me do X"). Balance facts and claims. Your documents will be boring and meaningless if they're just bare lists of facts. They will be empty and unbelievable if they are

just grand claims about yourself. Use each of the two or three paragraphs in the body of your letter to make a few key interpretive statements ("I enjoy selling aggressively"). Back up each one with some examples (e.g. "achieved the highest sales figure of 10 employees for the first quarter of 1999"). Mention that the résumé gives further specifications and make sure that it does. Write concisely. There's no space available for word-spinning. Prune your style by following any good writing guide or the U of T file on Wordiness.

Activities

Activity 1:

How can we decide whether a non-standard English usage is an "error" or an "innovation"? Does it depend entirely on whether the speaker is native or non-native, or are there other criteria, such as frequency of use, number of users, and so on (Jenkins, 2003)?

Activity 2:

What are the positive and negative consequences of the spread of English to an Outer Circle country like China (Mesthrie & Bhatt, 2008)?

Activity 3:

Do you believe it is possible to retain your L1 (first language) accent in other language(s) and still be intelligible to native speakers of that language? Have you had any personal experiences that support your view (Jenkins, 2003)?

Activity 4:

Find out as much you can about Indian English. What social and/or regional dialects of English are spoken in India? What sorts of attitudes to English pronunciation and/or usage can be

found among Indians? What do Indians think of other Expanding Circle varieties of English?

Activity 5:

Investigate aspects of the role of English or the learning and teaching of English in any country of the Expanding Circle (E.g., Russia, China, Sweden, Nepal) (Davies, 2005).

Activity 6:

Using a library or the Internet, try to find two texts in English, preferably from a single domain (e.g., newspaper editorials), but written about 50 years apart. Compare them to see how aspects of English usage have changed in the course of the period separating them (Davies, 2005).

Activity 7:

Using the Internet, compare reports from a range of international newspapers in English. What differences, if any, can you find between them in terms of their lexis, grammar, and spelling (Davies, 2005)?

Activity 8:

Find two or three texts (e.g. advertisements) which combine dialects in various ways and discuss the linguistic and stylistic effects produced by this combination. Consider the aims of the texts and how the use of more than one dialect contributes to these aims.

Activity 9:

Discuss, giving examples, whether or not the cultural context impacts the production of a new variety of English, and how (if so). What does the mixing of local languages with English accomplish for users of that English variety?

Activity 10:

Directions: Write a job application to the principal of M.A.O. College, Lahore for the post of lecturer in English and draft your CV in this regard. Give its covering letter also.

Activity 11:

Directions: Imagine that you are working in an office of a semi-government organization. You have to arrange for and attend the marriage party of your cousin. How will you draft your leave application?

Activity 12:

Directions: Write an application to the Chief Executive of WASA, Lahore regarding inadequate and polluted supply of drinking water in your locality.

EXERCISES LONG QUESTIONS

- Q1. Elucidate the introduction of writing different kinds of application.
- Q2. What do you know about writing different kinds of application.
- Q3. Describe the types of application letters.
- Q4. Describe the steps on how to write an application letter.
- Q5. Elucidate the summary of writing different kinds of applications.

SHORT QUESTIONS

- Q1. Describe shortly the introduction of writing different kinds of application.
- Q2. What do you know about writing different kinds of applications?

- Q3. Describe shortly the types of application letters.
- Q4. Describe shortly the steps on how to write an application letter.
- Q5. Describe shortly the summary of writing different kinds of applications.



Chapter 5

Preparing a Curriculum Vitae (CV), (Bio-Data) etc.

Student's Learning Outcomes:

After completing this chapter, the students will be able to;

- Your cover letter should be well-presented, concise, and to-the-point.
- Use an easy-to-read font.
- Do not use pictures for its decoration.
- Emphasis on your suitability for the job.
- The opening statement of the first paragraph should set out why you're writing the letter.
- In the second paragraph, cover what attracted you to this type of work, why you're interested in working for the company and what you can offer the organization.
- In the third paragraph, highlight relevant experience and demonstrate how your skills match the specific requirements of the job description.
- Summarize any additional strengths and explain how these could benefit the company.

THE RESUME

Introduction

A Resume is a concise document commonly used in the hiring process. It includes information about your background and qualifications and should communicate the most important, relevant information about you to employers in a clear, easy-to-

read format. Its objective is to quickly communicate why you are uniquely qualified for the position/ post applied for based on your qualification, skills and experiences. With any resume design, make sure that readers can find essential information in a matter of seconds.

PREPARING A CURRICULUM VITAE (CV), (BIO-DATA) ETC. THE RESUME

Length of resume

A resume typically should not be longer than one page, but it can be up to 5-7 pages depending upon the position of job for which it has been developed and designed.

Purpose of a resume

The purpose of a resume is to provide a summary of your experience, skills, education and professional achievements. Resumes are an important document which lets employers screen candidates and shortlist potential interviewees.

How should Resume look?

The design and layout of your resume should be neat and make it easy to read. Use one or two clear fonts and use headings, bullet points and paragraphs to split up the text. It should be free from spelling and grammar mistakes.

Steps/ guidelines for drafting your resume

Follow these steps when drafting a resume.

- (i) Start by choosing the right resume format.
- (ii) Include your name and contact information such as email address, phone number and mailing address. Your name should be highly visible at the top of your resume with a bolded or larger font than the rest of the document, but no more than a 14 point size.
- (iii) Add a resume summary or objective statement. An objective statement quickly explains your career

goals and is a good choice for those with limited professional experience.

- (iv) List your soft and hard skills.
- (v) List your professional history with keywords.
- (vi) Use keywords from the job description highlighting your achievements in the relevant job.
- (vii) You should keep your descriptions as concise and relevant as possible.
- (viii) Make a stronger impression by using action verbs to describe your professional achievements. Some examples include; managed, developed and saved.
- (ix) Proofread your resume carefully review your resume for spelling, grammar and punctuation errors. Get it reviewed by professors or some professional or family member if they can review your resume.

Dear [INSERT HIRING MANAGER'S NAME],

Regarding the [INSERT JOB TITLE] position currently advertised in The News International, please find attached a copy of my CV for your consideration. My CV contains detailed description of my academic qualification, professional qualification and the work experience.

Briefly stating, I have been studying [ADD RELEVANT DEGREE] and have already gained some experience as a [INSERT JOB TITLE] at [INSERT COMPANY NAME] where I [INSERT KEY RESPONSIBILITY OR ACHIEVEMENT].

I think my abilities [INSERT KEY SKILLS] would be a positive addition to your team. If you would like to get in touch to discuss my application and to arrange an interview, you can contact me via [INSERT PHONE NUMBER OR EMAIL ADDRESS].

I look forward to hearing from you as early as possible.

Yours sincerely,
[INSERT NAME]

THE CURRICULUM VITAE (CV)

A CV (short for the Latin phrase *curriculum vitae*, which means "course of life") is a detailed document highlighting your professional and academic history. CVs typically include information like work experience, achievements and awards, scholarships or grants you've earned, coursework, research projects and publications of your work.

A curriculum vitae (CV) provides a summary of your experience and skills. Typically, CVs for entry-level candidates are longer than resumes – at least two or three pages. CVs for mid-level candidates who have amassed numerous publications tend to run much longer.

CVs include extensive information on your academic background, including teaching experience, degrees, research, awards, publications, presentations, and other achievements. CVs are thus lengthier than resumes, and include more information, particularly details related to one's academic and research background.

The CV Summary

A curriculum vitae summary is a one-to-two-page, condensed version of a full curriculum vitae. A CV summary is a way to quickly and concisely convey one's skills and qualifications. Sometimes large organizations will initially ask for a one-page CV summary when they expect a large pool of applicants.

Writing of a CV

Most CVs include the following information:

- Personal information (name, parentage, nationality, marital status and religion etc.)
- Contact information
- Academic history
- Professional experience

- Qualifications and skills
- Awards and honors
- Publications
- Professional associations
- Grants and fellowships
- Licenses and certificates
- Volunteer work
- Personal information (Optional)
- Hobbies and interests (Optional)

CV Example Template

1. Personal Details

- Full name
- Parentage
- Date of birth, nationality, religion, domicile
- Residential and mailing address (including city, state and post code)
- Phone number
- E-mail address

For example:

Ahmad Ali

1234 Main Street, Iqbal Town, Lahore.30308

joe.t.smith@email.com

2. Profile (Career aims, career objective, Personal Profile)

A summary of your career plans. It should also depict your aims and goals on which you would like the employer to concentrate.

3. Education (Education / Qualifications and Experience)

- Qualifications and skills
- Awards and honors
- Publications
- Professional associations
- Grants and fellowships
- Licenses and certificates
- Volunteer work
- Personal information (Optional)
- Hobbies and interests (Optional)

CV Example Template

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A summary of your career plans. It should also depict your aims and goals on which you would like the employer to concentrate.

3. Education (Education / Qualifications and Experience)

- Post-doctoral program (if any)
- MA/ MSC (University/ College)
- BA/ BSC (College)
- HSSC (School)
- SSC (School)

For example:

Ph.D. in Sociology, 2018

University of Punjab , Lahore- Pakistan

4. Professional experience

- Organization or institution
- Job title/position
- Details about duties, experience and achievements

For example:

University of Punjab

Zoology Department 2012-2018

Taught multiple undergraduate and graduate courses.

5. Qualifications and skills (skills and achievements are an indication of the match between your abilities and job description)

- Hard skills
- Soft skills
- Accreditations and certifications

For example:

Team leadership

Fluent in English, and Urdu

Certification in English Language

6. Interests and Activities (this is a chance to present your character, and to show that you would be an valuable colleague.)

- Ability to be a team player
- Volunteering

- Decision-Making and problem-solving
- Yoga

7. Publications and presentations

- Publication citation (including authors, date, summary, volume, page, DOI number)
- Presentation details (including title, date and place of presentation)

8. References (You should provide the names of those persons with their contact numbers and addresses who have agreed to provide a reference for you.)

Tips for CV presentation

- Keep your CV brief and up to the mark. Don't stuff too much into your CV. The readers always read the key points.
- Avoid lengthy paragraphs and use bullet points.
- Use white space to spread out the information so that it is easy to read and the design is pleasing.
- Use a single font throughout and avoid over use of emphasis such as capitals, italics and bold letters.
- Limited use of colours looks attractive. Mark your CV out of the rest.

Tailoring your CV

While designing your CV for a job, you should tailor it according to the job specifications. The aim is to show your qualifications, skills and characteristics for each position you should carry out a mapping exercise between the main elements of the job description and your CV.

Second Opinion

Always get a second opinion about your CV and application letter. Request a trusted friend to check deeply all

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the CV so that an error free CV is submitted. Career service or your academic advisor may offer help in this regard.

BIO-DATA

Bio-Data is a 'biographical info' acronym. Bio-Data is a brief database that focuses on one's details such as date of birth, gender, ethnicity, nationality, place of residence, marital status, name of parents, contact information, current position, salary/ grade/ scale and mailing address etc. It also contains brief opening remarks about education, trainings and experiences in sequential order. A Bio-Data format is a text which is 1-2 pages long and collects individual information that can be used for different employments.

Purpose of Bio-Data

Bio-Data is a useful tool for organizations seeking to examine job applicants' backgrounds in a consistent, transparent, and fair manner.

A biodata is a job application document used in India, Pakistan and other South Asian countries, either instead of or as a supplement to a resume or CV. Here we'll discuss the differences among these documents, and how to prepare a biodata if you need one.

If you're not from India or neighboring countries, you may have never heard the word "biodata." But it's a commonly used document in South Asia for job applications — and even for matrimonial purposes, in which case it's also known as a "marriage resume."

What does 'biodata' mean?

Short for "biographical data," biodata is sometimes said to be nothing more than an antiquated term for a resume or CV. But there are also key differences, as a biodata typically provides more personal information than would normally be found in a resume/CV, including age, gender, marital status, religion and other personal details.

What does a biodata include?

Plenty of confusion is possible in defining a biodata and what it should contain, precisely because of the different types of biodata and their uses.

Biodata for personal use

Below are the two most common types of biodata for personal use.

Biodata for marriage

A marriage biodata can describe a significant number of personal details, such as the person's height, weight, race and complexion — all of which would be unthinkable to include in a resume or CV. A marriage biodata is a unique type of document in this regard, where professional credentials are replaced with mainly individual information pertinent to potential matrimonial goals.

Biodata for marriage purposes usually includes information about one's parents and siblings, including their occupations, education and where they live, as family status can be very important in Asian cultures in determining whether a man and woman are a suitable match for marriage.

In fact, just about anything you might be curious about in seeking a life partner can be relevant in a biodata for marriage: whether you smoke or drink, your hobbies and interests, whether you're a vegetarian, and even horoscope information. But little or none of this belongs on a biodata submitted in search of a job.

Medical biodata

Another type of information sometimes requested is medical biodata, which might include blood type, genotype and any information on disabilities, allergies or health conditions like asthma.

Medical biodata may be required by schools or employers to assess a candidate's overall health, or for use in case of a

PREPARING A CURRICULUM VITAE

medical emergency. For the same reason, "Next of kin/emergency contact" may be included in the medical biodata.

But this is another type of information that would never be included on a normal resume or CV.

Expert Tip

By the way, if you're wondering about the differences between a resume and a CV, the words *usually* (but not always) mean the same thing, although the word "resume" is used in the U.S. and Canada and the word "CV" (curriculum vitae) is more common in other countries.

So while medical biodata (or simply biodata) may refer to a similar document, it's a word you'll typically hear only in South Asian countries, including India, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, Nepal and Afghanistan.

Biodata for a western resumes

You can easily take Western resumes as a solid basis for a work biodata, but be mindful of the subtle nuances mentioned above, as well as any regional details that may be relevant. Remember to conduct research about the position and the employer before writing the document, just as you would for a resume or CV.

Expert Tip

This YouTube video, produced by the Centre for Languages and Communication, provides a detailed overview of the difference between resume, CV and biodata application documents.

Biodata for job

Like a resume or CV, biodata for employment should include five basic components: personal info, a summary/profile (or an objective, depending on your career status), work history, educational credentials, and job-related skills. If you review

resume.io's detailed guide to how to write a resume, most of that advice is applicable to a biodata as well.

Other than personal info, all of these components of a work biodata are virtually identical to those of a resume or CV. One exception: employment and education history are usually presented in chronological order in a biodata for work, while reverse chronological order is favored for resumes and CVs.

Biodata personal info

This is the tricky part of creating your own biodata — how much personal information you're expected to include.

Some employers offer forms to fill out that specify all the information they're seeking, eliminating the guesswork for you about what to include. But for those that don't, here are some guidelines:

As in an ordinary resume, biodata persona info includes: your name, occupation, address, phone number and email. All of these would normally appear in the header of a resume.

- What about date of birth? To prevent age discrimination, this is normally not included in Western resumes, but would not be unusual in a biodata, so include this if you wish.
- Gender or race? These are not included on ordinary resumes for the same reasons, to prevent any hiring discrimination, although your gender may be obvious from your name, and both gender and race may be obvious if you include a photo. (For that matter, some employers discourage the use of photos in Western resumes.)
- Nationality? This may or may not be relevant, though a person from one country applying for a job in another may face visa or work permission issues.
- Religion? This is generally not an employer's business, though if you're applying for a job with some religious affiliation, it may be prudent to mention yours.

- Parents' names, occupations and education would generally be irrelevant to an employer. So would your marital status, height, weight and complexion.
- Hobbies and interests are sometimes included even on Western resumes and CVs, although it's generally not recommended unless these have some bearing on your job-related skills. But these are considered totally acceptable in a biodata.

Biodata summary/profile/objective

Known alternately as a biodata summary, profile (or resume objective if you're facing a career change), this is a paragraph of text under the header that describes your occupation and professional specialization. It may specifically state your employment objective — exactly what type of job you're looking for — or this may be obvious if all the experience you mention is in the same field.

This summary often omits the word "I" and isn't necessarily written in complete sentences. (For example: "Elementary school teacher with 12 years of experience teaching grades 1-3, now seeking a challenging position in a private school instructing grades 4-6.")

This is the one place in your biodata where you have the liberty to describe yourself and your professional qualifications in your own words. It should be thoughtfully written to present yourself in the best light possible, ideally making a hiring manager sit up and take note that you sound like a promising job candidate.

Biodata employment history

Always include your employment history in a biodata, resume or CV — unless you have none because you're still in school. However, in such a case you should include any internships or volunteer work you've done in fields relevant to the job you're seeking.

If you have a long job history, you may opt to leave out some jobs unrelated to the field in which you're seeking work. The rule of thumb is to not go beyond the last 10 years of

employment and five to eight previous jobs (depending on how long their descriptions or lists of achievements are).

When listing past jobs, include where they were and how long you worked there. List bullet points describing what you actually did there. Be specific, using facts and figures whenever possible — sales figures, the number of clients you handled, percentage revenue increases you generated, etc.

As noted, it's somewhat more common in biodata to list jobs in chronological order (first job first), but reverse chronological order (last job first) is often also acceptable as with traditional Western resumes.

Biodata education section

List your high school, any colleges or universities you attended in your biodata education section, the years you studied there, and any degrees obtained. You can also highlight any special achievements, such as a high grade point average or academic awards you received.

If you have any special certifications in your field, you can also list those here. And again, it's more common in biodata to list past schools in chronological order.

If you have a university degree, it's sometimes considered unnecessary to include your high school, although there's no harm in doing so.

Biodata skills section

As in a resume or CV, a biodata will generally contain a short list of job-related skills, such as computer applications you know how to use or languages you speak.

The skills section often includes a mix of soft skills ("people skills" like collaboration and communication) and hard skills ("expert C/UNIX programmer," for example).

Do your best to avoid clichés that recruiters have seen a thousand times before, like "Self-starter" or "Detail-oriented". Try to use original language highlighting skills that most other job candidates won't have on their list.

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Biodata format

Most of the design and formatting rules that apply to resumes and CVs apply also to the biodata format. A one-page document is usually considered ideal for busy hiring managers to scan quickly, although it's not unusual to see a biodata that's two or three pages.

All biodata formats should start with an attractively designed header containing the candidate's name and contact info. Additional personal info may be displayed along one side of the page.

The job candidate's profile/summary/objective should come under the header. This is generally followed by work experience, and then by education, although if a candidate has impressive educational credentials but thin work experience, the education section can come first if you want to format your biodata as a fresher.

COVER LETTER

A Cover Letter is a document sent alongside with CV when applying for jobs. This letter is necessary as it gives you the chance to explain to an employer why you're the best candidate for the job. In this, relevant skills, qualifications and experience are highlighted. Cover letter should complement your CV but not duplicate it. Typically, three to five short paragraphs should be in a cover letter. It should not exceed one A4 page.

Guidelines for Writing a Cover Letter

- (i) Your cover letter should be well-presented, concise, and to-the-point.
- (ii) Use an easy-to-read font.
- (iii) Do not use pictures for its decoration.
- (iv) Emphasis on your suitability for the job.
- (v) The opening statement of first paragraph should set out why you're writing the letter.

- (vi) In the second paragraph, cover what attracted you to this type of work, why you're interested in working for the company and what you can offer the organisation.
- (vii) In the third paragraph, highlight relevant experience and demonstrate how your skills match the specific requirements of the job description.
- (viii) Summarise any additional strengths and explain how these could benefit the company.
- (ix) The last paragraph, round up your letter. Reiterate your interest in the role and indicate your desire for a personal interview.
- (x) Once finished read through the document and cut out any unnecessary words and sentences. Don't fill up space by repeating what's already covered in your CV.
- (xi) Always try and address your cover letter directly to the person who will be reading it or who advertised the job.

Sample of a Cover Letter

City A.B.C.

March 22nd, 2021.

To

Chief Executive Officer,
Orient Company,
City X.Y.Z.

Subject: Application for the post of Assistant Manager

Respected Sir/ Madam,

With due respect, it is stated that I am sending the attached application for the above-cited post lying vacant at your Head Office, advertised in "Dawn" Lahore, dated February 25th, 2021. My CV is also attached herewith. My application and CV will prove me the best candidate for this post.

Sir/ Madam! Kindly examine my application favorably in the light of application and CV.

Yours Truly,

(Singnature)

Name

Cell #

Email

Summary

A Resume is a concise document commonly used in the hiring process. It includes information about your background and qualifications and should communicate the most important, relevant information about you to employers in a clear, easy-to-read format. Its objective is to quickly communicate why you are uniquely qualified for the position/ post applied for based on your qualification, skills and experiences. With any resume design, make sure that readers can find essential information in a matter of seconds. A CV (short for the Latin phrase curriculum vitae, which means "course of life") is a detailed document highlighting your professional and academic history. CVs typically include information like work experience, achievements and awards, scholarships or grants you've earned, coursework, research projects and publications of your work. A curriculum vitae (CV) provides a summary of your experience and skills. Typically, CVs for entry-level candidates are longer than resumes – at least two or three pages. CVs for mid-level candidates who have amassed numerous publications tend to run much longer. CVs include extensive information on your academic background, including teaching experience, degrees, research, awards, publications, presentations, and other achievements. CVs are thus lengthier than resumes, and include more information, particularly details related to one's academic and research background. Bio-Data is a 'biographical info' acronym. Bio-Data is a brief database that focuses on details such as date of birth, gender, ethnicity, nationality, place of residence, marital status, name of parents, contact information, current position, salary/ grade/ scale and mailing

address etc. It also contains brief opening remarks about education, training and experiences in sequential order. A Bio-Data format is a text which is 1-2 pages long and collects individual information that can be used for different employments.

Activities

Activity 1:

Directions: Prepare your Resume and CV. This Resume should be for the post of General Manager in Samsung. Write the covering letter for it also.

Activity 2:

Directions: Prepare your Bio-Data sheet.

Activity 3:

Homework: I suggest rather than start resume writing activity straight away; you should sit with a pen and a paper and write down what you are. It is a lot easier to say than to do!!! Yes for this you need to know yourself. The chances are you have not revealed your true self in the professional world, but you should know what you are best at. By knowing this you will be able to jot down a few things about you:

1. What your interests are?
2. What do you really want to do in life?
3. Your personality type introvert or extrovert or both

So now that you have known yourself this much, that you can develop few sections of your resume such as your hobbies, your area of interest and your goals in life which is actually your career objective or two initial lines in resume writing techniques. I generally say they are resume taglines of an individual.

Let me relate this:

1. Career Objective or tagline: "A determined professional with a pleasant personality has the confidence to crack any

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sales deal with innovative selling ideas. The capability to develop from zero to finalization of the deal is what my convincing skills can do for any organization". Here I have done a few things while resuming writing activity this Career objective.

2. Playing with words: I have tried to be fresh, innovative and creative. Why because for the position of sales there are tons of resume, but my resume can one make a difference when I have beautifully developed my taglines, in such a way that they are conveying a professional meaning but with the freshness.
3. Confidence to show your skills on paper; many times we are not that confident to write what our real skills are in our resume. This is where the discrepancy comes in the recruiter has seen something your resume but actually, you are not that one which he assumes you to be.
4. I should know about myself that I am a great communicator, a traveler and a creative person. Now, I can do this with ease when I have done the homework already.
5. Further, we can add one or two more lines in case you have done your MBA from the premier institute or you have scored great marks in your last education.
6. Further, if you have experience than you can write what achievements you have had in your past organizations. There could be other things that you have in you, but you need to dig within you for that and homework is the best tool.

A word of Caution: I suggest you should write your achievements and awards in context to the job applied for. Let's say you have received the award in dramatics, but it is not advisable to write in the career objective, as this is not in context to your job. This will create a negative impression about you on the recruiter.

Activity 4:

Develop Headings: I totally disagree with the fact that you should follow a set format available over google these days' blindfold. One thing should be very clear in resume writing. Remember it is all about reflecting everything which is best about you. While I write this line, I may sound confusing to some.

Let me elaborate more upon this: Taking the sales position in consideration again: comparing two people from the same sales team, however, you have not done well in your academics but now in job you are the best performer so for such people the next heading should be of "professional Achievements" and not Qualifications.

Example two: You are a fresher but you have been working part-time than you should showcase this in your career objective again your work experience heading should come first and then you can place your qualification heading below that.

So you see how we can tweak the resume when you wish you so that you can highlight the best in you first and the rest can come later on.

Tips:

1. When you don't have achievements: you can mention your best qualities/hobbies: such as stability, honesty, networking, event planning skills, taken interest in academics, writing books, poetry, sports knowledge, freelance assignments are done, photography etc. write what is your real passion, not just because you have to fill the CV.
2. Important is to manage space so finalize the headings according to space. The matter within the headings should also be in an appropriate format, let's say: Achievements can be in points. Your qualification can be in the tabular format.

Activity 5:

Selection of Format: For me, this is ranked three and not two because the headings have to be developed first and later you should work on the format and spacing. I include the look and feel as well in the format section. If you are from the art field your CV headings should be in the stylish font. If you are a teacher your CV should be simple and systematic but not clumsy.

Moving on to formats:

There are tons of formats these days available for you; I differ again that CV formats are new or old, but what I feel is your format should be best suited for you. For this, you can try a few formats before finalizing upon one. But the format should be such which should grab attention.

Tip: It is the format which is first seen and not the content or words! So always keep in mind that your format should shine out and should say loud, pick me and give those 30 seconds to my resume.

Activity 6:

Resume Writing activity Content: Since your format is amazing the content should not lack behind, your format has given your content that chance to be called for interview. However, if you lack behind in your content then you may lose the chance of getting an interview call.

Within content as well I divide this into three parts:

1. **Deciding what to write:** While resume writing activity you should write professionally required qualities, hobbies, and interests. If you are in sales better to write I am a communicator rather than writing I am a dance topper. Further, in reading here you can take the name of books which are related to finance and marketing from your domain and in newspaper articles you can say, my morning routine includes reading the marketing segment where I can keep myself updated with the latest

happenings in the market. BUT WRITE THIS ONLY WHEN YOU DO IT REALLY ON DAILY BASIS, else you can mention, that I am keen to know more from my network what is the new development in our industry.

2. How to present: In your resume writing activity your content has to be systematic, synchronized and presentable. Means the headings should be bold and all headings should be of same size and font. Further, your heading has to be apt, like education or qualification which one to choose from these two. Similarly, professional snapshot or professional highlights or professional achievements. Decide very carefully what should be the correct heading.

Tip:

1. First, develop the content and lastly decide the heading.
2. Deciding about heading depends upon the profession you are in, your years of experience and your content.
3. Knowing how much to write: You know of an incidence where you have done exceptionally well. But here you have to write in one line. Write in rough and reduce it to one line. Further, you don't know much about that subject still you are writing I know about this, I have great knowledge about so and so, and this will only generate a negative impression. Mind your words, where you need to give emphasis - suppose you are expert of one area - say I have mastered this domain. For others, you can say I have fair good knowledge about this. Or I am a beginner in this domain; this will give the real image about you.
4. Should I use percentage and figures in my content or should I use adverbs for exemplary work: In case you have been working for target-oriented roles or you have been heading a large team or being head of an institution. You should write figures, as in all these conditions figures are revealed to you. But in case you are in the Operations

department, where quantifying output is sometimes tough and then you can use words instead of figures.

Activity 7:

Analysing Overall Presentation of CV: It happens that you have given undue spacing to low weight headings. Suppose you have given 7 lines to the hobbies section and 3-4 points towards your professional growth. This will reflect that you have been giving more emphasis towards your hobby and less towards your profession. If you don't have more points/content to write towards professional growth, I suggest cut down on your hobbies as well.

Tip:

You can introduce another heading in case you have so much of vacant space.

You can play with font size and paragraph spacing, to increase the space or vice versa.

In case you are going too lengthy, you can try using proper words to reduce the sentence length. Like I have been doing this - you can replace simply with one word "Did presentation during the first quarter with elite clients".

Activity 8:

Review Content again: You should review content for three important categories

1. Grammatical and language correction
2. Using correct sentences under the defined heading.
3. Lastly, modify language for crisp and SEO friendly Keywords.

Activity 9:

Evaluate and compare

1. Show it to someone who knows you in and out could be your best friend, your parent or your mentor so that he can make out what you actually are and what is written is

making sense as per your personality and you have not missed on to anything.

2. Evaluation means to rate your resume, better will be to show your resume to the experienced person. That person can check your *resume for formatting*, overall look and feel and any errors if he finds.
3. Moving next show this to the language expert or someone who is good at English.
4. Now, you can search over google resumes for the similar position that you have applied for. Now by this, you can have more ideas and concepts of formats, presentation style etc. the reason why this was not told in the initial stages there will **not** be any originality in your resume.

Activity 10:

Final Revision: By now, you have your resume writing activity done and ready with you. I will say it is 90% job done, as there are a lot more chances that you have missed on some important information in your resume, which you can recall in later times. Best is to have past inspection done for the work done, you can check your emails for that. In case you maintaining a diary check with that. Or you can connect back with your JD and KRA. Referring back to all these things you can find missing links.

Activity 11:

Continuous Process: Resume writing activity is a one-time thing but it is always good to keep on updating the resume for better opportunities. There are chances that you wish to develop a new format or to give new look and feel to your old resume. Ideally, when you have completed 5 years in your career it's time to change the format and make it better and interesting. Regular reviewing will give a better understanding. You can also compare your old resume with the new one. Or you can make different types of resume according to different roles over the years if you have acquired.

Activity 12:

Resume is your reflection: If there is nothing interesting in your resume, in terms of achievements, rewards, promotions job accomplishments. It's time for introspection and acting accordingly. You can pursue any further educational course, attend Conferences and build your repo in the present organization. Get active in taking part in the events happening in your organization, rather than leading a dull life. See your resume and check in which sections you can add. Keep building on it's never too late to have a great resume

EXERCISES

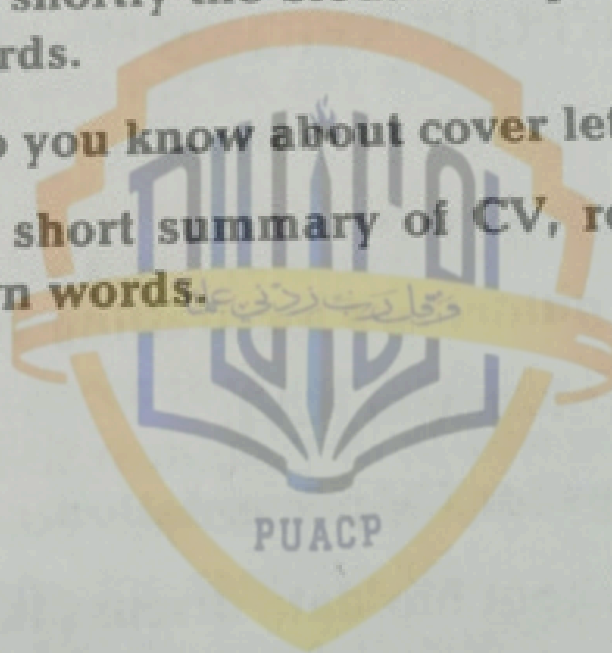
LONG QUESTIONS

- Q1. Elaborate the introduction of a resume.
- Q2. Elucidate the purpose of a resume.
- Q3. Describe the steps/ guidelines for drafting your resume.
- Q4. Elucidate the curriculum vita (CV).
- Q5. Put a light on the tips for CV presentation.
- Q6. What do you know about bio-data discuss it.
- Q7. Elucidate the biodata for a marriage.
- Q8. Elaborate the biodata for a job.
- Q9. Discuss the biodata employment history in your own words.
- Q10. What do you know about cover letter.
- Q11. Write the summary of CV, resume and bio-data in your own words.

SHORT QUESTIONS

- Q1. What does 'biodata' mean?
- Q2. What does a biodata include?
- Q3. Describe shortly the introduction of a resume.

- Q4. Describe shortly the purpose of a resume.
- Q5. Describe shortly the steps/ guidelines for drafting your resume.
- Q6. Elucidate the curriculum vita (CV).
- Q7. Put a short light on the tips for CV presentation.
- Q8. What do you know about bio-data discuss it shortly.
- Q9. Describe shortly the biodata for a marriage.
- Q10. Discuss shortly the bio-data for a job.
- Q11. Discuss shortly the biodata employment history in your own words.
- Q12. What do you know about cover letter define it.
- Q13. Write a short summary of CV, resume and bio-data in your own words.



Chapter 6

Writing Short Reports

Student's Learning Outcomes:

After completing this chapter, the students will be able to;

- Decide on a structure. Typically, there are a number of basic elements found in a formal report. But in writing a short report, it might be necessary for you to summarize these into only what is required to support the given topic.
- Focus on what is necessary. Emphasize significant points and eliminate those that aren't too relevant to the topic.
- In a long report, a writer generally does not use the first person (I or WE).
- The writer generally use third-person reference in some tactful ways in it.
- Glossary, table of contents and references are subsidiary parts of a formal report.

Introduction

A report is a short, sharp, and concise document which is written for a particular purpose. It generally sets out and analyzes a situation or problem, often making recommendations for future action. It is a factual paper, and needs to be clear and well-structured. They are often used to communicate the results and findings etc. Reports are usually assessed on content, structure, layout, language, and referencing. In this unit, we shall discuss different dimensions of the report.

WRITING SHORT REPORTS

We associate reports with long paragraphs printed on a stack of papers, but this may not always be the case for some. Sometimes, we are asked to write a short technical report for a given matter. This type of report may be used for numerous reasons, one of which would be for quick yet informative reading.

Writing a Short Report Outline

A short report is meant to be just that, short. Although, it can be quite difficult to do so especially since there's a lot to cover. In writing a short report, or for any free report examples for that matter, it's best to create an outline.

- To do this, you first need to identify your topic. With a topic in mind, it will be easier for you to specify the key points that need to be emphasized in the report.
- Next, you have to arrange these points in a logical order.
- Once this is done, identify subpoints that provide supporting details to the main point of your free outline.
- Finally, review the outline you have made. This will allow you to make the necessary changes for parts that do not make much sense.

When you're finished with your outline, you may now make the final paper.

Summary of the Short Report

When you think about a short report, it's basically a short executive summary of a given research or topic being covered. To create a summary for the report, it's best to take note of all the major points that are considered to be important in conveying the overall message.

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Purpose of a Short Report

Short reports may be used for various purposes. They could be used in creating a business report or even a project report. For example, a construction firm is responsible for a number of major projects in the city. To provide updates on the progress of such development, a short report is written each month. Through this, the firm may monitor current operations and address certain issues immediately.

To put it simply, a short report provides the reader with a concise but detailed narrative that proves to be significant for their understanding.

Guidelines for Writing a Short Report

- Choose an approach. A top-down approach is advisable for writing a short report where the stages of identifying the scope, gathering information, and refining are involved.
- Decide on a structure. Typically, there are a number of basic elements found in a formal report. But in writing a short report, it might be necessary for you to summarize these into only what is required to support the given topic.
- Focus on what is necessary. Emphasize significant points and eliminate those that aren't too relevant to the topic.
- Keep sentences short. It's important to keep your report informative yet straight to the point. You can do so by constructing statements in pdf with proper wording.
- Consider your layout. When presenting graphs, charts, and other images to your report, make sure that the text supports what is seen in these visuals. Be sure to organize these in your report.

KINDS OF REPORTS

Reports may be oral or written. An oral report is a piece of face to face communication about something seen or observed. A written report is relatively permanent and accurate. It can be referred again and again. The written report is formal than oral report. There are following common types of written reports;

(i) The Informal/ Short Report

An informational report provides background and information without reaching an evaluation. These include simple reports like meeting minutes, expense reports, and progress, or status updates. An informal report does not have a set length, but should be as brief as possible.

(ii) The Formal/ Long Report

A long report is a long formal document.

- It needs to be well planned, well researched, and well structured.
- In style, a long report is impersonal.
- It is restrained in tone.
- In a long report, a writer generally does not use the first person (I or WE).
- The writer generally use third-person reference in some tactful ways in it.
- Glossary, table of contents and references are subsidiary parts of a formal report.

While writing a long report like Proposal Report, Research Report, Academic Report, and Technical Report, you should find accurate information, solve problems, and organize and present your ideas clearly.

Summary

When you think about a short report, it's basically a short executive summary of a given research or topic being covered.

To create a summary for the report, it's best to take note of all the major points that are considered to be important in conveying the overall message. Short reports may be used for various purposes. They could be used in creating a *business report* or even a *project report*. For example, a construction firm is responsible for a number of major projects in the city. To provide updates on the progress of such development, a short report is written each month. Through this, the firm may monitor current operations and address certain issues immediately. To put it simply, a short report provides the reader with a concise but detailed narrative that proves to be significant for their understanding. An informational report provides background and information without reaching an evaluation. These include simple reports like meeting minutes, expense reports, and **progress**, or **status** updates. An informal report does not have a set length, but should be as brief as possible. A long report is a long formal document.. It needs to be well planned, **well** researched, and well structured. In style, a long report is **impersonal**. It is restrained in tone. In a long report, a writer generally does not use the **first person** (I or WE).

Activities

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Activity 1:

Project information: Any activity report should include key information that identifies the project, all members of the team, and the most up to date status on project's progress (i.e., "we are just beginning the project," "we are half way through producing the deliverable," or "we are putting the final touches on our work").

Activity 2:

Project tasks: In addition to these identifying details, activity reports should articulate project tasks that have been completed, tasks currently underway, and what tasks are

needed to complete the project in a timely manner. This information should communicate what each team member is working on so as to expedite the reader's communicating of questions or concerns.

Your description of completed tasks, current activities, and responsibilities going forward should inform your reader of the project's timeline and its estimated time of completion.

Activity 3:

Describe any challenges: Activity reports should identify any challenges encountered, with particular reference to possible actions that can mitigate or avoid these obstacles in the future. Describing these difficulties will also provide reasoning for the project's timeline and whether it is maintained or modified. Keeping managers and fellow employees in the loop on difficulties also provides an opening for you to ask for additional resources, time, or help on the work going forward.

EXERCISES

LONG QUESTIONS

- Q1. Elaborate the introduction of writing short reports.
- Q2. Elucidate the writing a short report outline.
- Q3. Describe the purpose of the short report.
- Q4. Discuss the guidelines for writing a short report.
- Q5. Discuss the kinds of reports.
- Q6. Write the summary of writing short reports.

SHORT QUESTIONS

- Q1. Describe shortly the introduction of writing short reports.
- Q2. Describe shortly the writing a short report outline.

ANSWERS KEY

3. Describe shortly the purpose of the short report.
4. Discuss shortly the guidelines for writing a short report.
5. Discuss briefly the kinds of reports.
6. Write the short summary of writing short reports.

